Shih Hsuan (Alvin) Lo

Portfolio

Pratt Institute

Interior Design MFA 26'

Shih Hsuan (Alvin) Lo

Shih Hsuan (Alvin) Lo is an interior designer based between New York and Taipei. His work explores the relationship between materiality, atmosphere, and spatial narrative through hospitality, residential, and adaptive reuse projects.

Before pursuing design, Alvin studied English Literature, a background that continues to influence his interest in storytelling and the emotional experience of space. He recently earned his Master of Fine Arts in Interior Design from Pratt Institute.

His work has been recognized through international design competitions and publications, including a shortlisted entry in the **Buildner Architect's Chair Competition** and a featured built project in **Vogue Taiwan.**

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EXPERIENCE

Freelance Interior Designer
Lo Studios | Taipei / New York — 2025 - Present

Independently designed and completed "YingLi Tea House", which was later featured on Vogue Taiwan.

Interior Designer Intern
Celano Design Studio | New York — 2025

Architectural Intern
Studio RAI Architects | New York — 2024

Research Assistant
Pratt ITL — 2024 - 2025

Interior Designer Assistant
One Planet Design | Taiwan — 2022 - 2023

EDUCATION

Pratt Institute
Master of Fine Arts (MFA) Interior Design — 2023 - 2026

Tamkang University
Bachelor of Arts (BA) English Literature — 2018 - 2022

AWARDS & PUBLICATIONS

Buildner
Architect's Chair #4 — Shortlisted

Vogue Taiwan
YingLi Tea House — Featured Built Project

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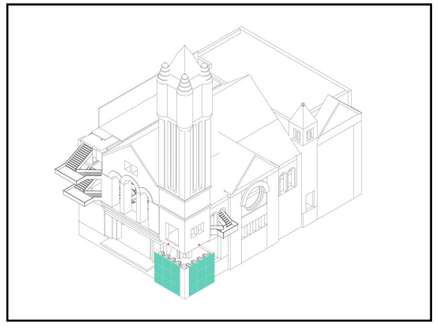

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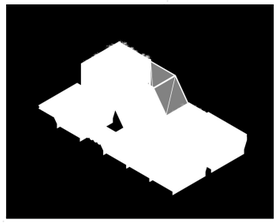

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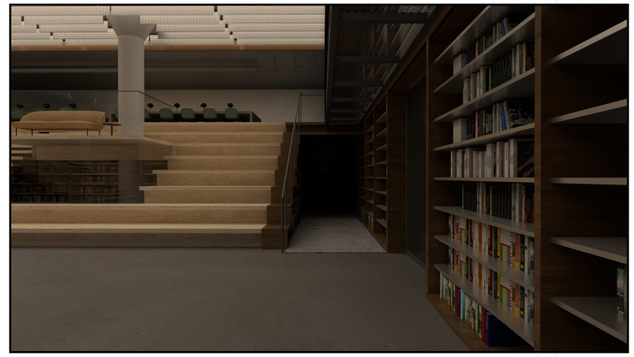

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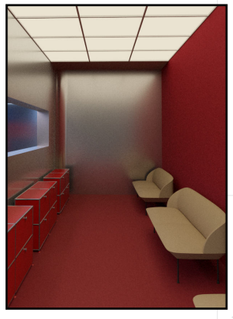

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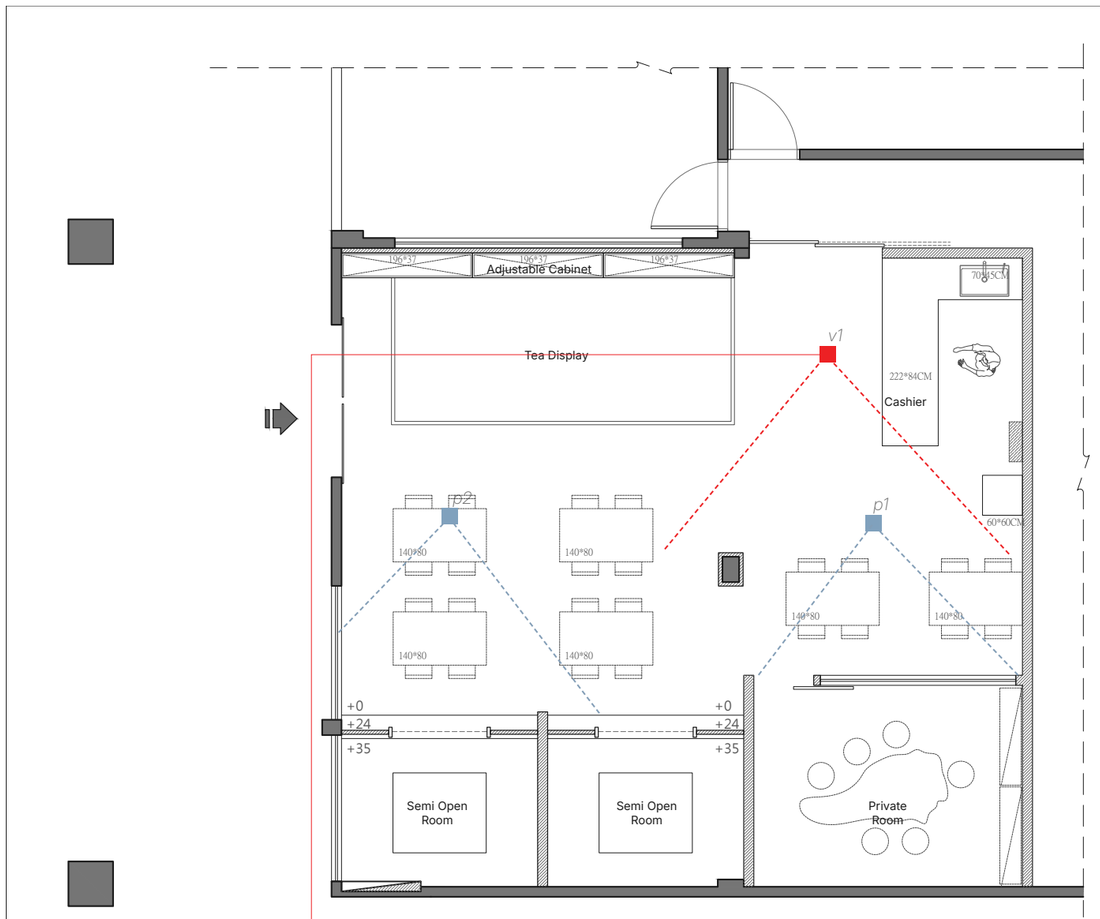
Night view of the storefront. Photo taken by Shih Hsuan Lo

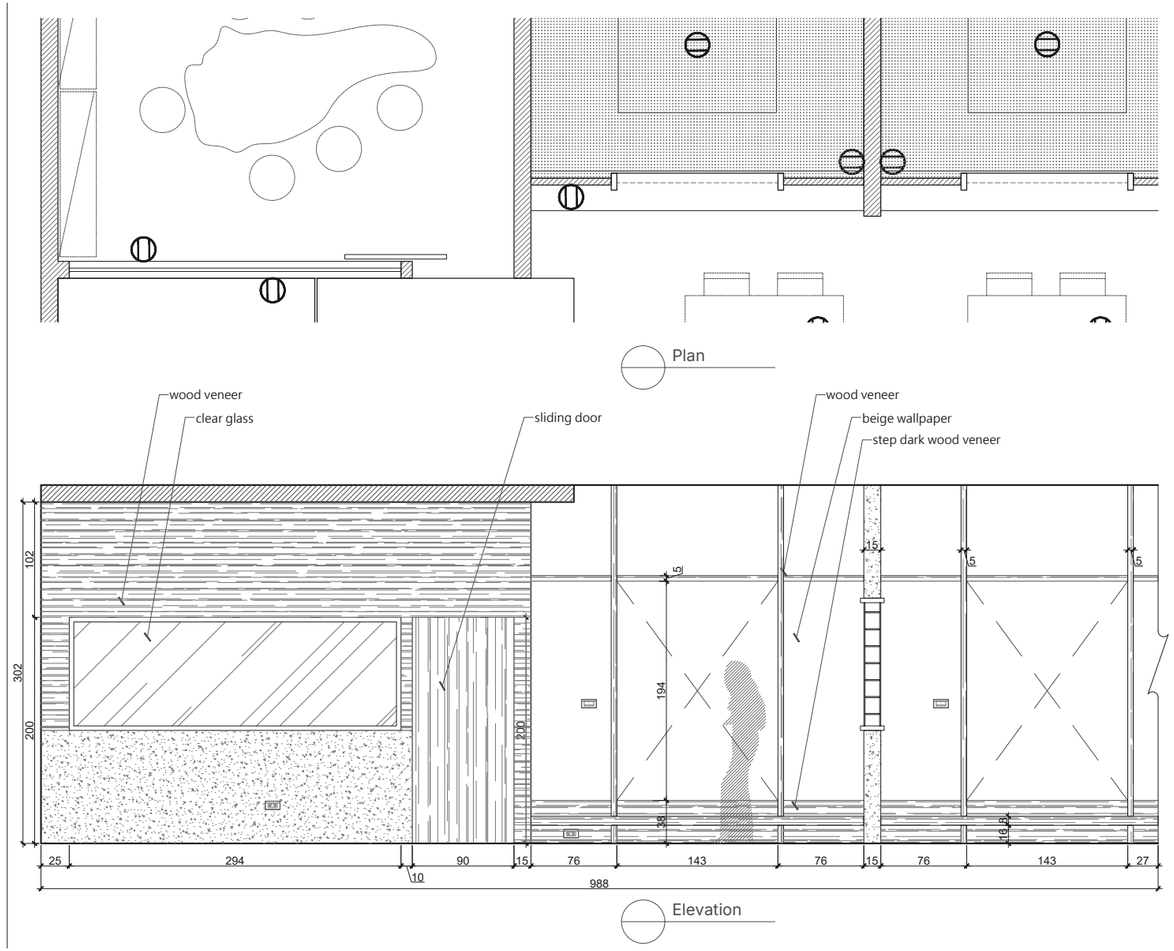
A Taste of the Slow, Deliberate Traditions of Old.

YingLi Tea House is built upon a profound respect for heritage and an unwavering commitment to quality. As the brand's first dedicated tea-tasting space in Taichung, this project marks a significant milestone in their journey. Entrusted with the creative direction from concept to completion, I sought to translate YingLi's core values into a physical experience that honors the past while embracing the present.

In an era of rapid pace, the traditional rituals of tea-drinking and the thoughtful gesture of tea-gifting are slowly being forgotten. The design of YingLi Tea House was conceived to revive these cultural touchstones.

The space is more than a retail environment; it is a curated retreat designed for connection. By balancing material honesty with functional elegance, we created a setting where customers can slow down and rediscover the simple joy of spending quality time with loved ones over an exceptional cup of tea.

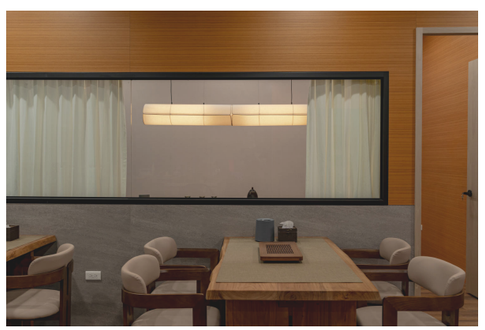




Render v1

The tea house is organized into three zones with varying levels of privacy to meet the client's needs, while maintaining visual connections throughout the space.

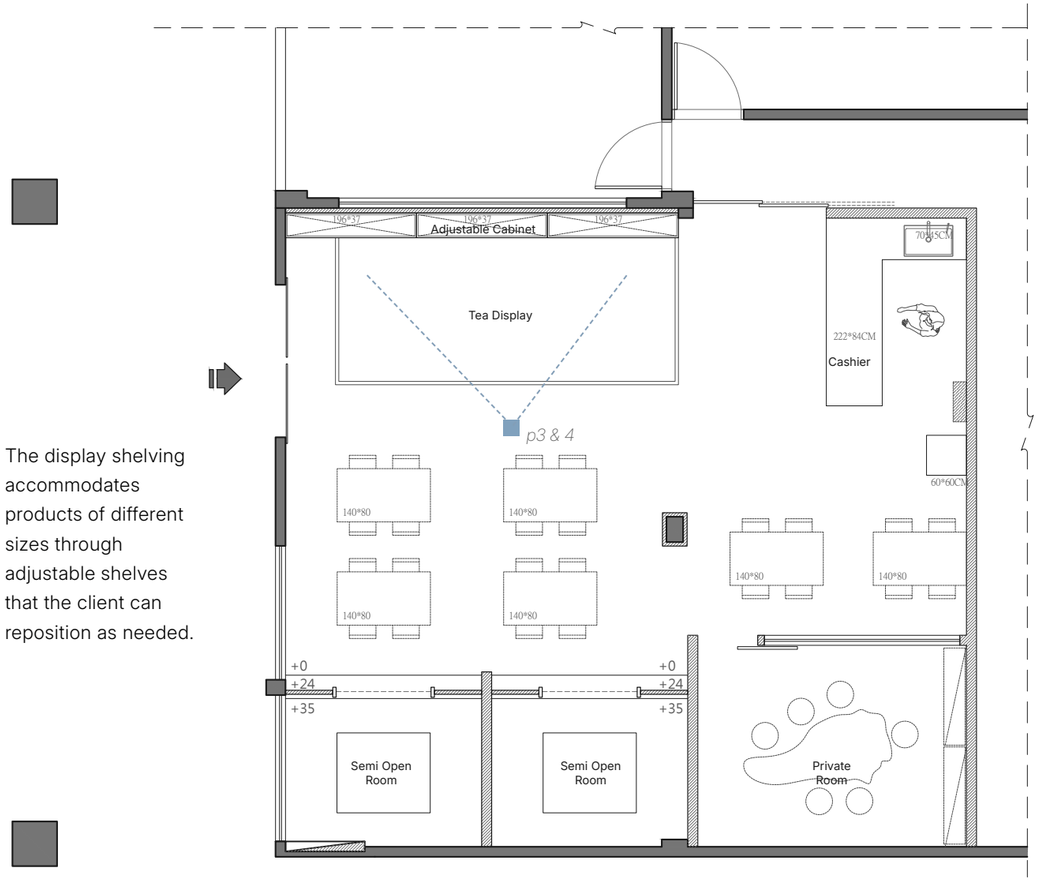
The private room accommodates 7–10 people, providing a quiet, uninterrupted experience.



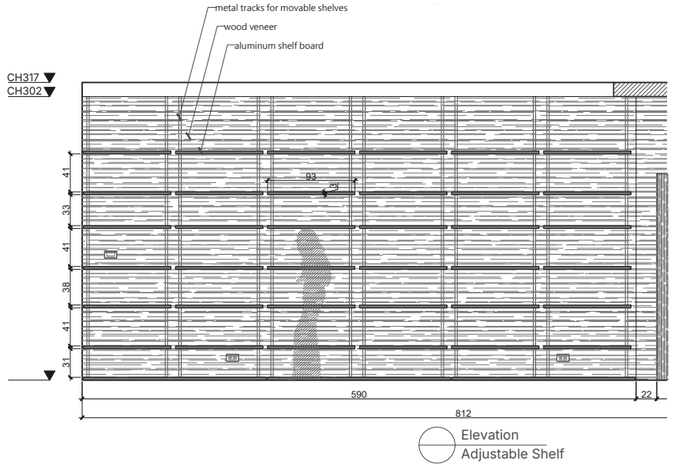
P1. Photo on site after completion

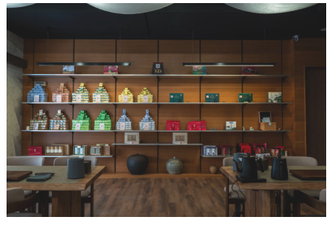
The semi-open areas accommodate groups of different sizes, from larger parties to small gatherings.

P2. Photo on site after completion



The display shelving accommodates products of different sizes through adjustable shelves that the client can reposition as needed.





P3. Configuration 1 of the display shelf.

P4. Configuration 2 of the display shelf.

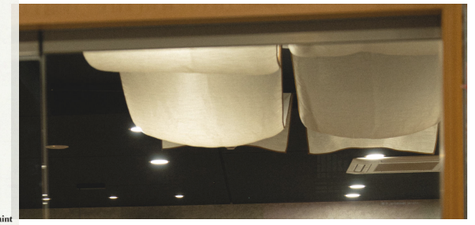


Photo of ceiling fabric after completion

Photo of storefront after completion

The interior is defined by a minimalist material palette, orchestrating a quiet dialogue between heritage and modernity. Fabric structure spans the ceiling, acting as a soft canopy that diffuses light across the space. This intentional layering of texture not only softens the visual landscape but also creates a tranquil, immersive environment where guests can truly slow down.

Present Absence

Site: New York, NY
May 2026. Academic
Individual Work

MFA Interior Design
Thesis - 2026

Pratt Institute
Advisor: Edwin Zawadzki

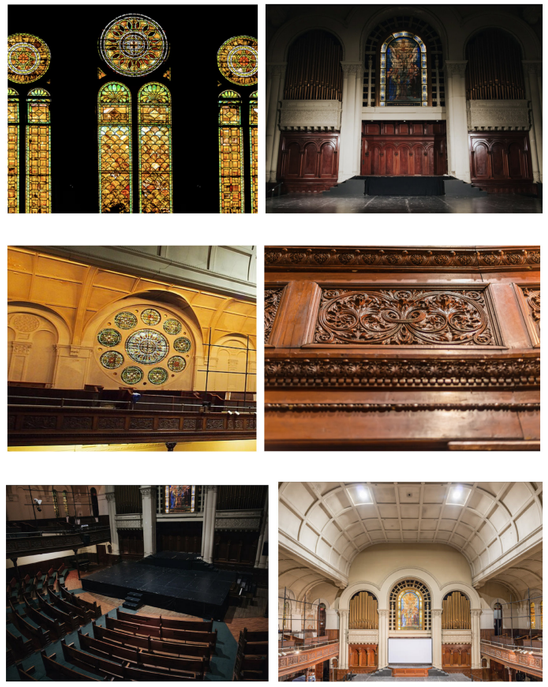
Abstract

This study originates from the urban tensions experienced in Taiwan—specifically the friction between developmental pressures and community identity—but addresses a phenomenon that is globally pervasive. In major metropolises like New York, the relentless push for urban renewal often necessitates the erasure of collective memory, resulting in the loss of vital community hubs and cultural spaces. This research posits that while redevelopment is an economic and structural necessity, the “spirit” of a site can be preserved through a strategy of architectural reinterpretation. By utilizing concrete casting to fossilize existing artifacts and strategically expanding or inserting new programs within the historical fabric, the design seeks to transform the interior into a “register of memory” that honors the past while serving the future.

Major cities like New York are facing rapid redevelopment that erases everyday environments as gentrification accelerates. This lived experience shapes the core of the research: the belief that memory is not a static record but an atmosphere shaped by material traces, absence, and the social life they support.

Existing condition of the site.

How do we preserve the memory of meaningful spaces?



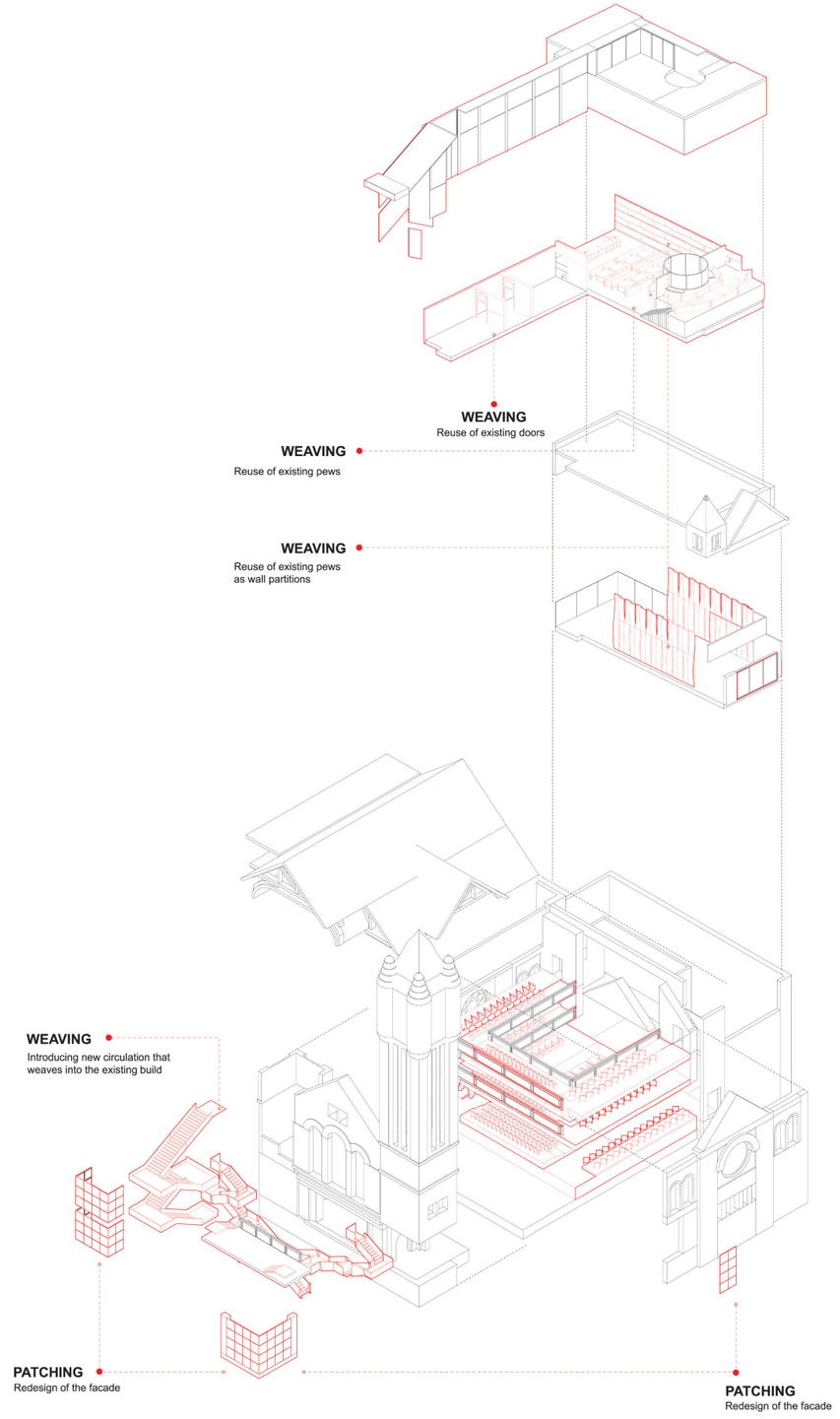
Existing interior references

Existing plans / red indicates proposed removal

Stained glass, carved timber, pews and spatial proportions form the material vocabulary of the intervention.

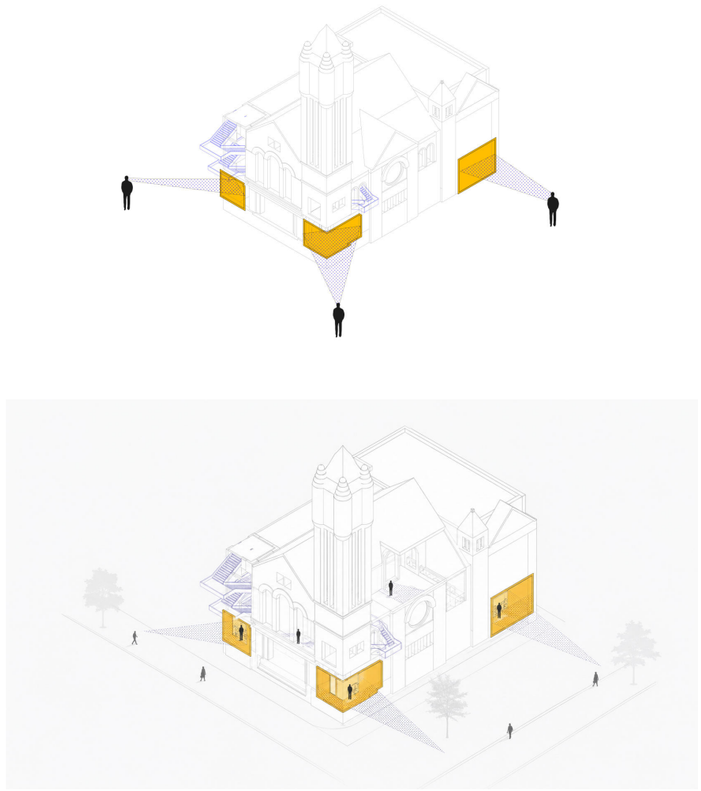
Selective subtraction opens a relationship to the street; new programs occupy and reconnect the interior.

The thesis approaches the church as both a material inheritance and a place of collective use. Its proposal retains recognizable traces while introducing spaces for gathering and performance.



West Park Presbyterian Church integrated with the proposed design by Shih Hsuan Lo

Design Strategy



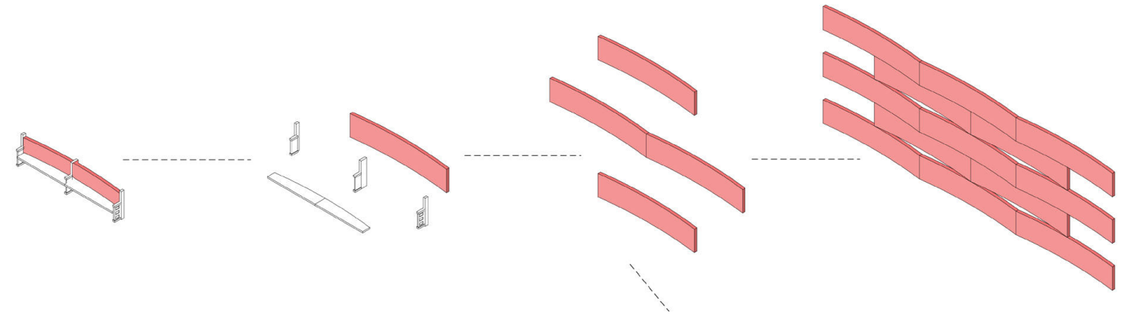
Opening the facade encourages public views into the interior.

Public gaze / Everyday community life

Drawing on Jane Jacobs's idea of "eyes on the street," the proposal opens the church to public view and everyday use. Selective facade openings connect activity inside with people on the street. Together with community-oriented programs, this strategy seeks to sustain social interaction beyond scheduled performances, returning the interior to the wider community.

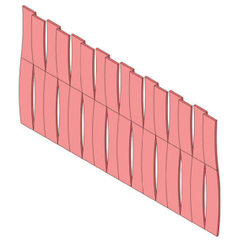
Jane Jacobs, The Death and Life of Great American Cities (Vintage Books, 1992).

Patching the Interiors



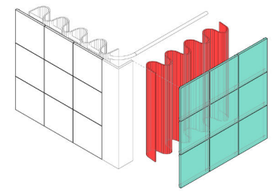
Existing pews disassembled and reassembled into partitions.

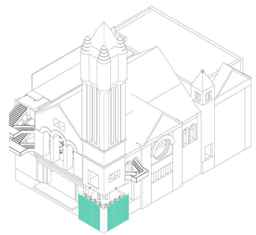
Reuse existing architectural elements by integrating new interventions with the building's existing character. Original door frames and pews are preserved and reused as key components of the redesign, creating a cohesive relationship between old and new.



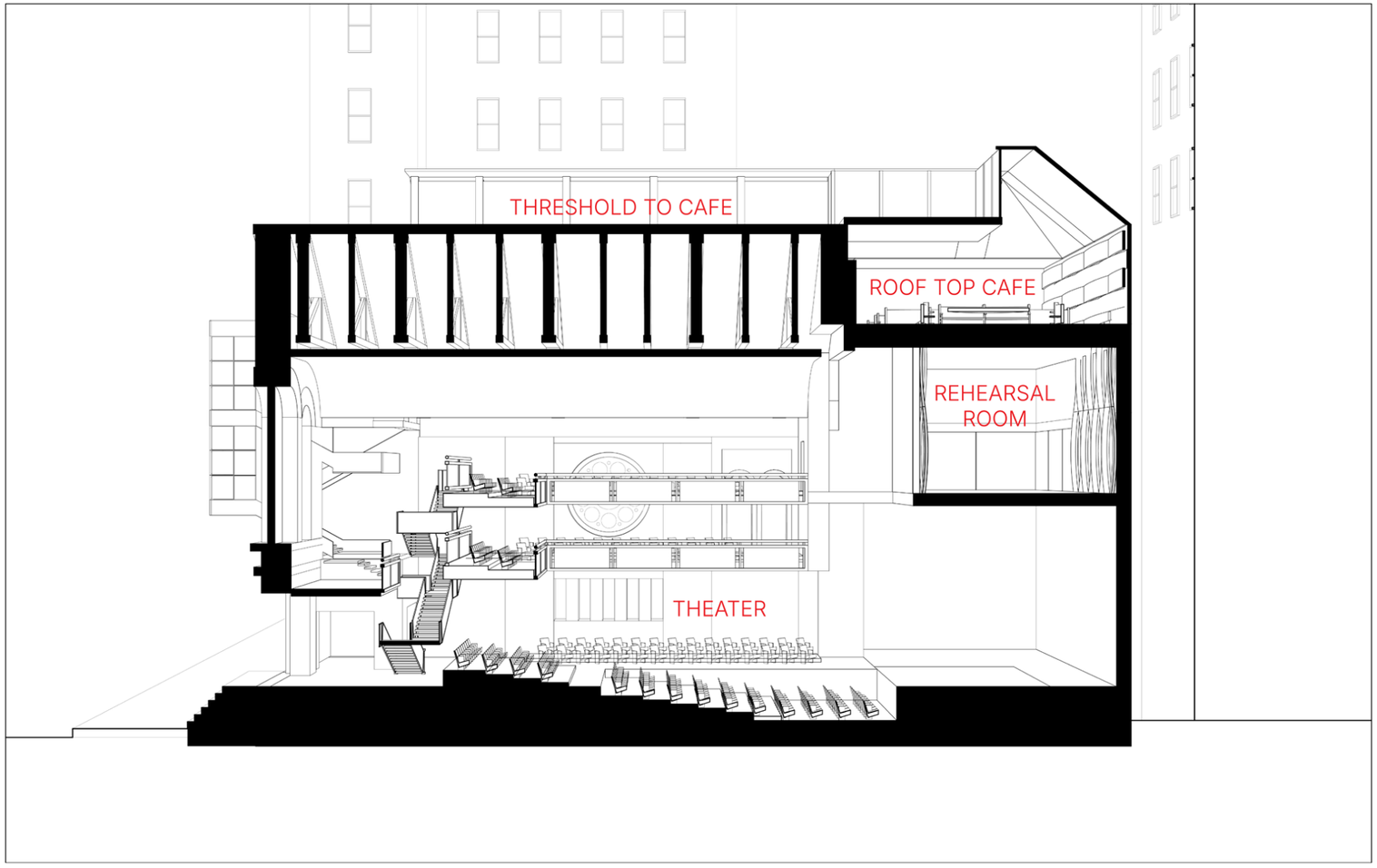
Patching the Facade

Selected portions of the exterior facade are removed to support new uses and encourage interaction between the community and the building's occupants. Glass panels and curtains patch these openings, providing flexible levels of visual accessibility and softening the boundary between interior and exterior. This intervention opens the building outward and gives the space back to the community.



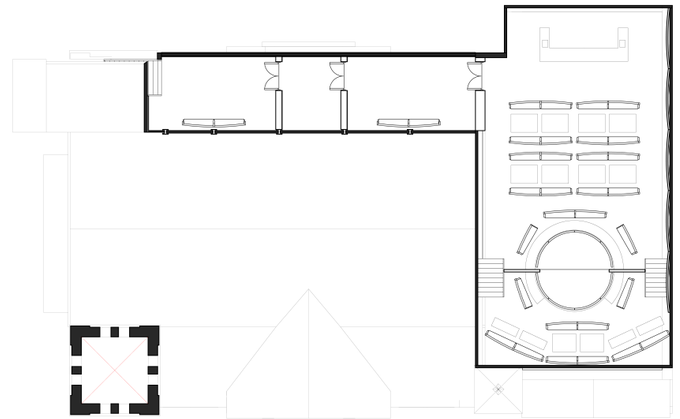


Glass and curtains / selective facade infill

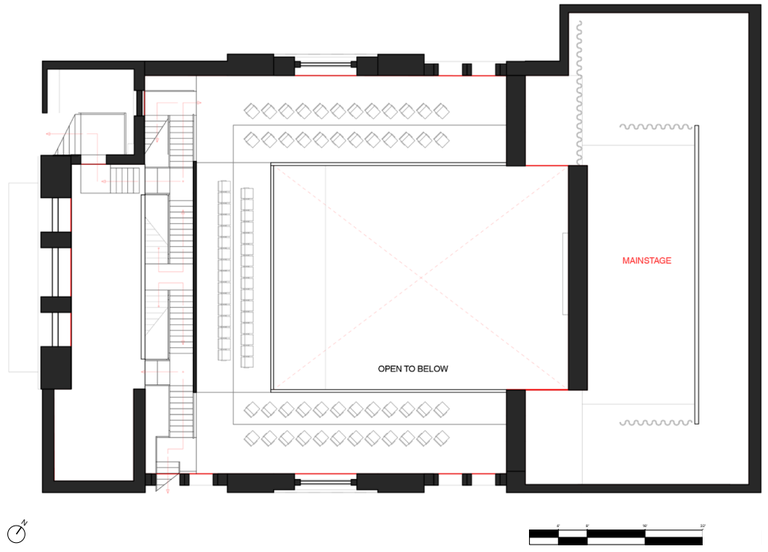


Theater / rehearsal / rooftop cafe

Responding to the church's deterioration, the proposal reimagines it as a community space with a rooftop café, a rehearsal room, and a theater open to the public. These interconnected programs bring together everyday gathering, creative practice, and performance, carrying the building's cultural memory forward through renewed social use.



04 / Cafe level



02 / Upper theater level

THEATER

Theater in use / community performance

Seating and stage

Curtains drawn / performance

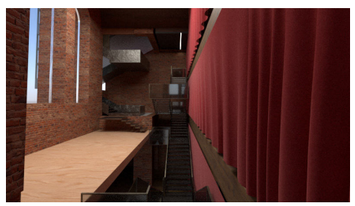
Curtains open / daylight

The theater stands at the core of the intervention, inheriting the structural presence and spatial memory of West Park Presbyterian Church. By opening the facade, the design creates visual access from the public realm while allowing natural light to enter the performance space when no events are taking place. The red curtains act as both a functional and atmospheric layer: they echo the tones of the existing red sandstone and brick, while providing flexibility to control visibility, light, and enclosure. Through this balance of openness and concealment, the theater becomes a space that can shift between public transparency and performative intimacy.

TRANSITIONAL SPACES

Staircase leading to the rooftop cafe

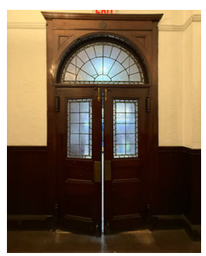
Stair / theater and waiting area



Stair / curtains drawn

Threshold / reused door frame

All newly introduced programs are connected by a single staircase that weaves through the church, moving between the existing structure and the new intervention. The stair becomes a spatial seam, combining preserved materials with newly added elements to create a dialogue between old and new. Facing outward, visitors encounter the street through the glass facade, which patches and redefines the exterior opening. As the path continues upward, it leads into a threshold where the existing church door frame is reintroduced, guiding movement toward the rooftop cafe while carrying traces of the building's former identity.

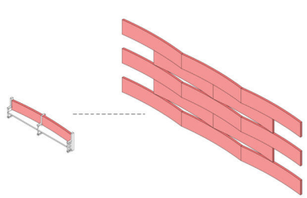


Existing church door frame

ROOFTOP CAFE

Rooftop cafe / existing pews in everyday use

Rooftop cafe interior



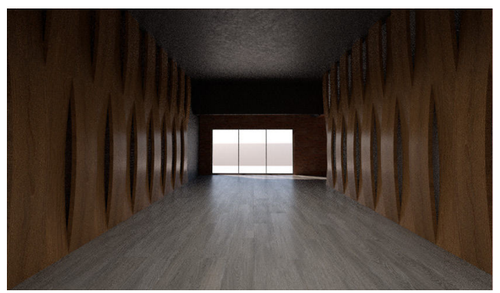
Type A / pews reassembled

Existing church pews

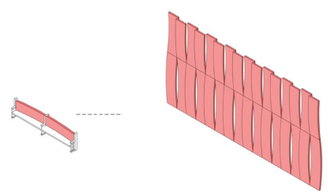
The rooftop cafe reuses pews from the existing church in two ways: as furniture and as wall partitions. As seating, the pews allow visitors to physically engage with familiar objects from the building's past, turning everyday use into an act of remembrance. As partitions, the backs of the pews are detached and reassembled into screens that define the cafe while blending into the new design language. Through this transformation, the original objects are not preserved as static artifacts, but reintroduced as active elements that carry memory into the new program.

REHEARSAL ROOM

Rehearsal room in use



Pew components reused as wall partitions



Type B / partition strategy

In the rehearsal room, the existing pews are reused as partitions, continuing the material strategy introduced in the rooftop cafe. Here, however, the wood boards are reassembled into a layered wall system, creating small pockets and layered surfaces intended to improve the acoustic condition of the room. Facing outward, the rehearsal space opens toward the street view of New York, allowing the city to become part of the practice environment. Through this arrangement, the room combines material memory, acoustic intent, and urban presence within a flexible space for performance and preparation.

Floating Community

Site: Key West, FL 33040 (Garrison Bight)
Instructor: David Ling - INT 702
May 2025. Academic
Individual Work

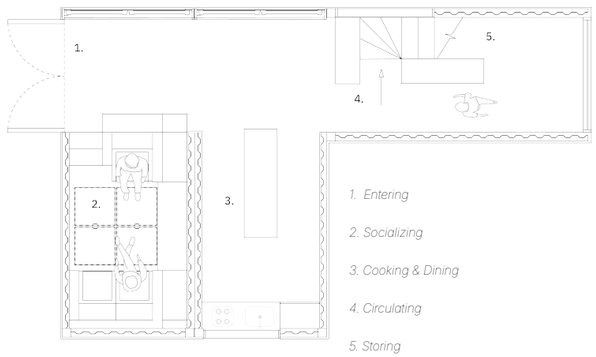
Digital Model
Rendering

Rhino 7
V-Ray

A Floating Solution For The Future In Key West

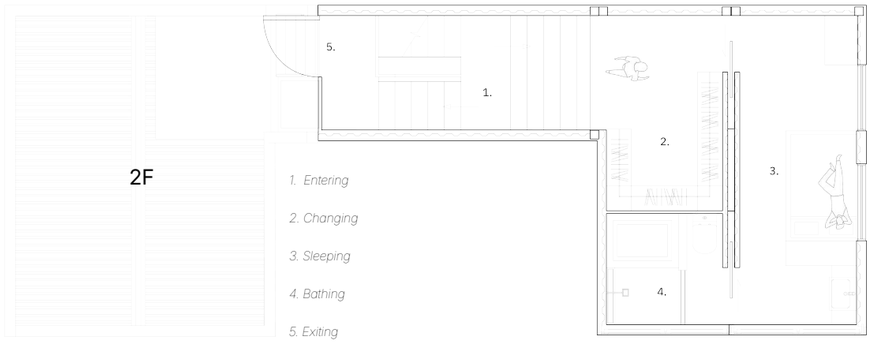
For decades, Earth has faced mounting pressures from overpopulation, with soaring housing prices becoming a global issue. Floating habitats are not new, but continue to evolve alongside technology. In Key West, Florida—famed for its waters and coastal life—visitors come to taste life on the water, while some residents live year-round in houseboats. In such environments, compact design is essential, and modularity is the element that elevates both function and flexibility.

This design blends civic hub and private refuge by repurposing shipping containers into interconnected modules that expand and contract as needed. Vertical spaces anchor the community core, while container dwellings shape shaded, airy negative spaces that invite activity. A rooftop garden strengthens connections to nature, and solar energy reduces reliance on traditional power. Each hub serves a distinct purpose, together forming a flexible, evolving environment that celebrates both individuality and collective well-being.



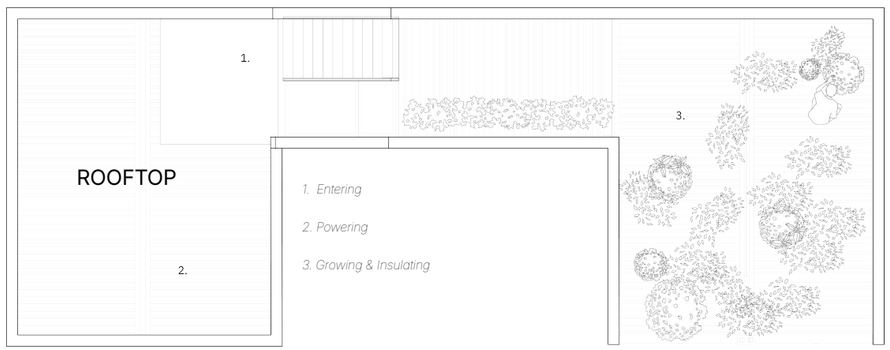
1F

1. Entering
2. Socializing
3. Cooking & Dining
4. Circulating
5. Storing



2F

1. Entering
2. Changing
3. Sleeping
4. Bathing
5. Exiting

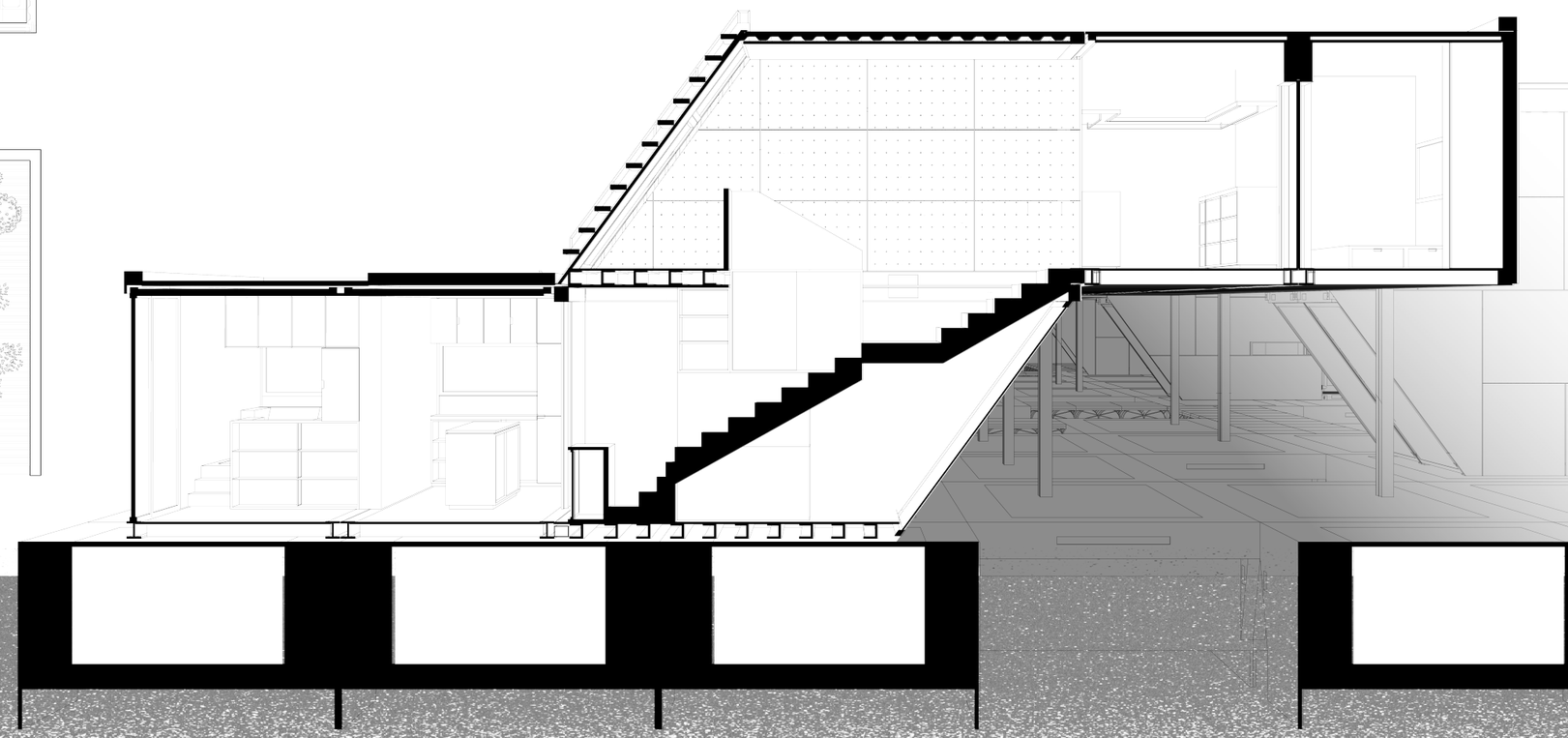


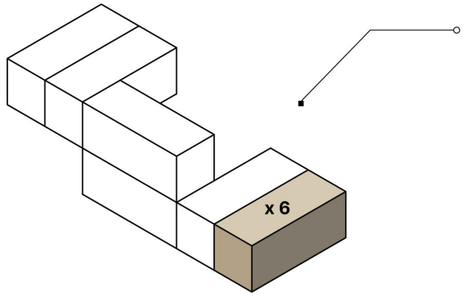
ROOFTOP

1. Entering
2. Powering
3. Growing & Insulating

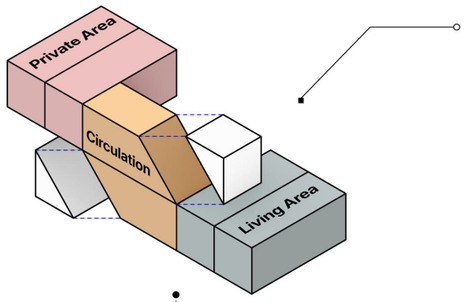
PROTOTYPE DESIGN

The prototype is designed to support a household of two and includes a living room, kitchen, staircase, walk-in closet, bedroom, and bathroom. The design also integrates dedicated areas for solar panels and a rooftop garden. When connected to neighboring modules, these rooftop gardens merge to create a shared communal landscape for residents, encouraging social interaction while supporting a more sustainable floating community.

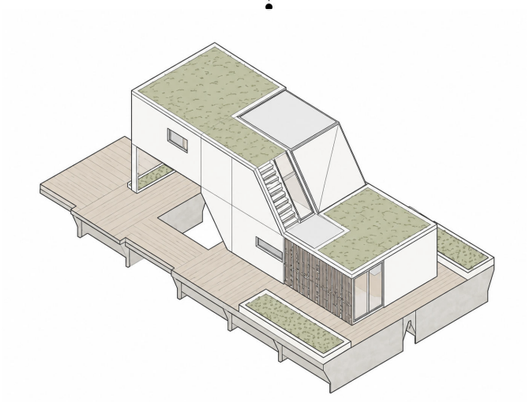




The prototype comprises six salvaged shipping containers, each with approximately 150 sq ft of floor area.



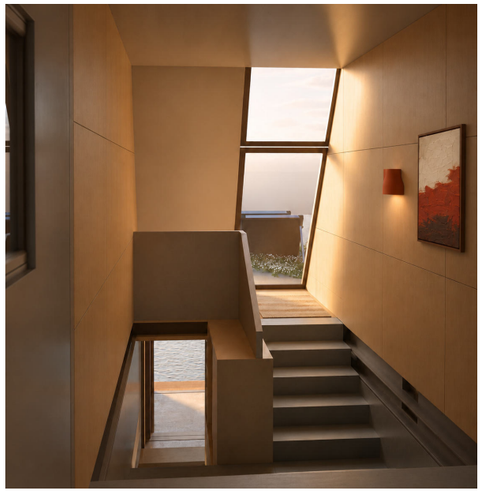
Each program occupies 300 sq ft. The sloped roof adds usable space above and increases headroom below.



The rooftop garden provides a natural cooling layer and connects neighboring modules through shared outdoor space.

MODULE INTERIORS

All furniture within the residential module is designed as built-in millwork, integrating seating, cabinetry and storage into the architecture. In the living room, additional storage is concealed beneath the raised platform.



Stair / vertical circulation

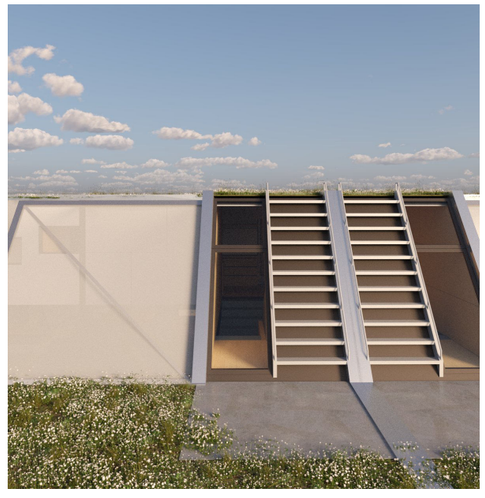
An internal stair connects the module's living levels.

Interior / integrated millwork

Built-in cabinetry forms part of the module's interior architecture.

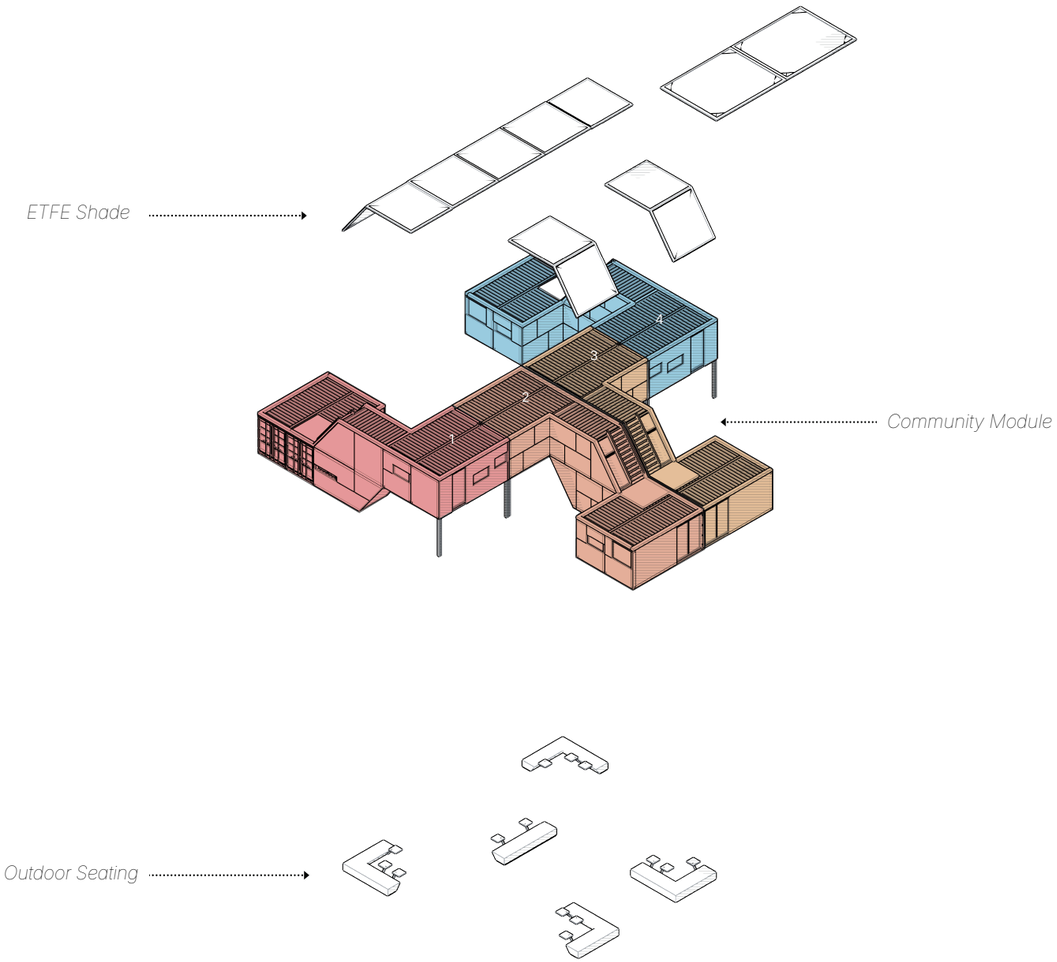
Living room / raised platform

Built-in seating and shelving, with storage beneath the raised platform.

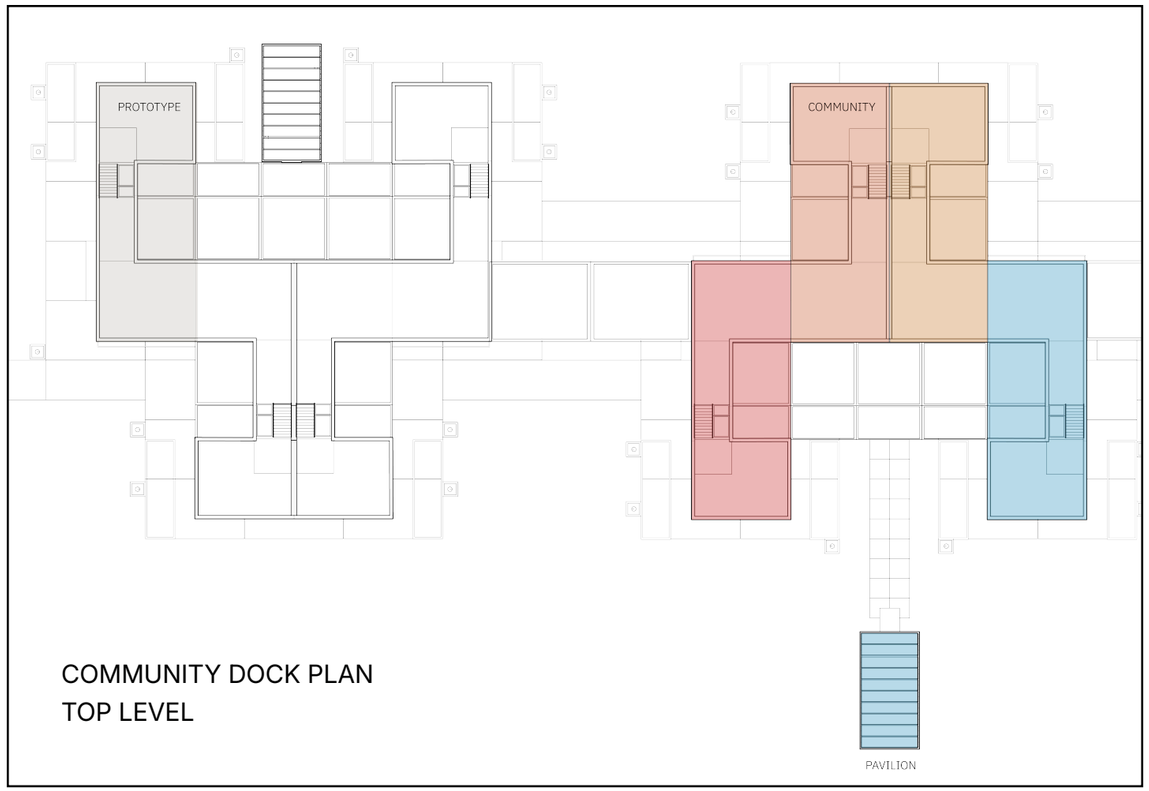


Rooftop access

A stair connects the module to the rooftop garden.

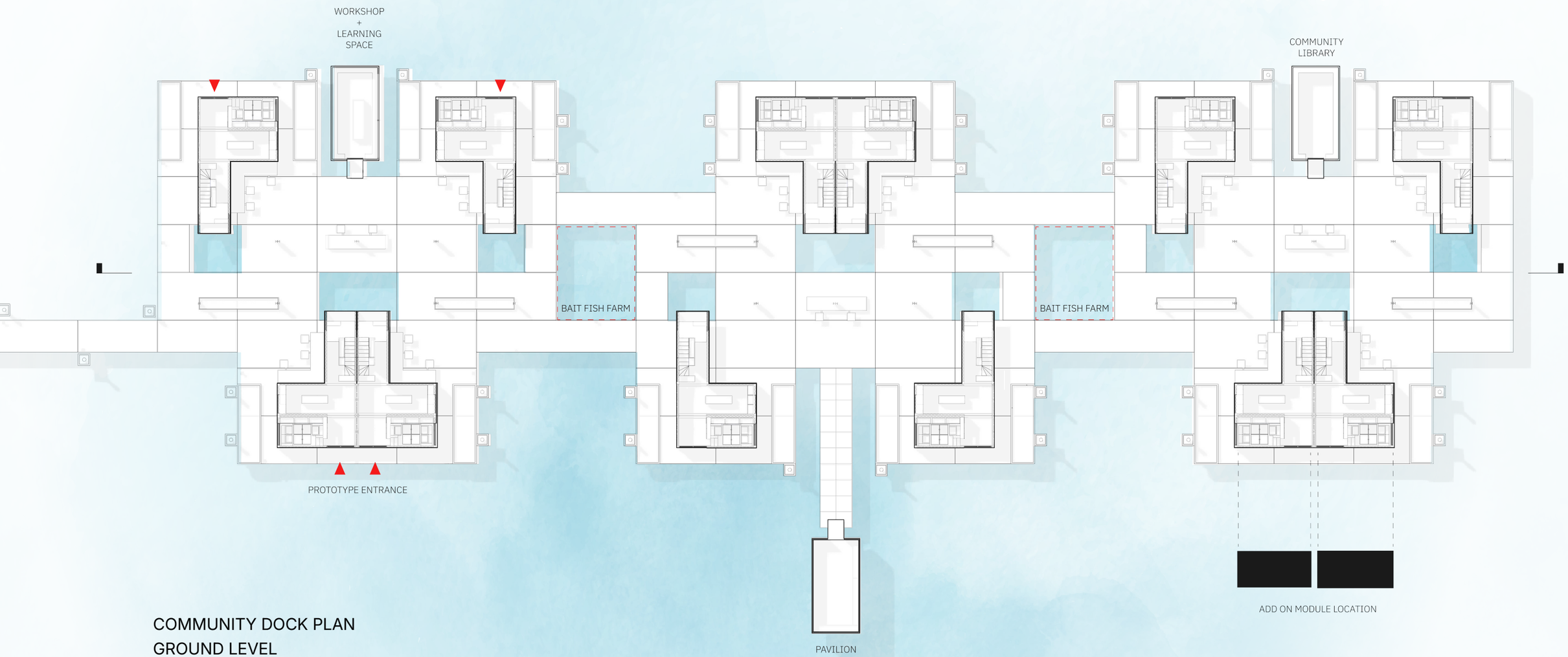


Community Module

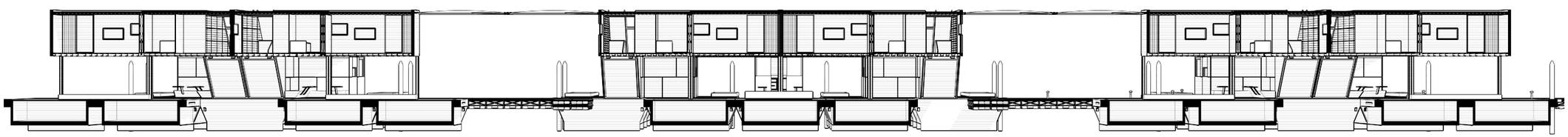


COMMUNITY DOCK PLAN
TOP LEVEL

Each community module comprises four prototypes, with their rooftop gardens merging to create a shared community garden. Within every community, a dedicated floating pavilion is introduced, each offering a unique program. As more communities are added, a greater variety of pavilions becomes part of the overall collective.



COMMUNITY DOCK PLAN
GROUND LEVEL

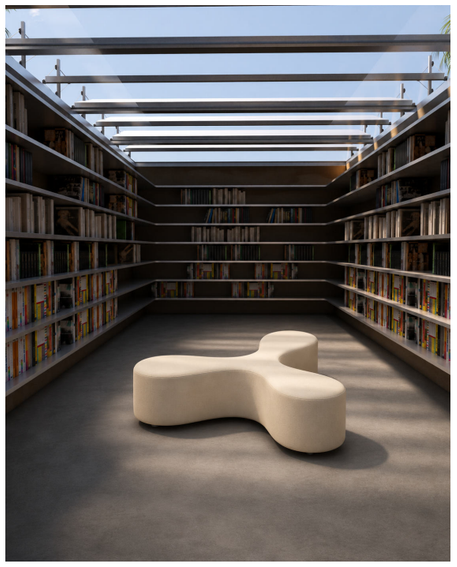


32 33

Pavilions serve different functions depending on the needs of each community, such as libraries, workshop spaces, or event cafés.

Community Space

The area beneath the prototype is designed as a public space that fosters community activity. Given Key West's warm climate, ETFE shades are installed along the sides to provide protection and prevent overexposure to the intense sun.

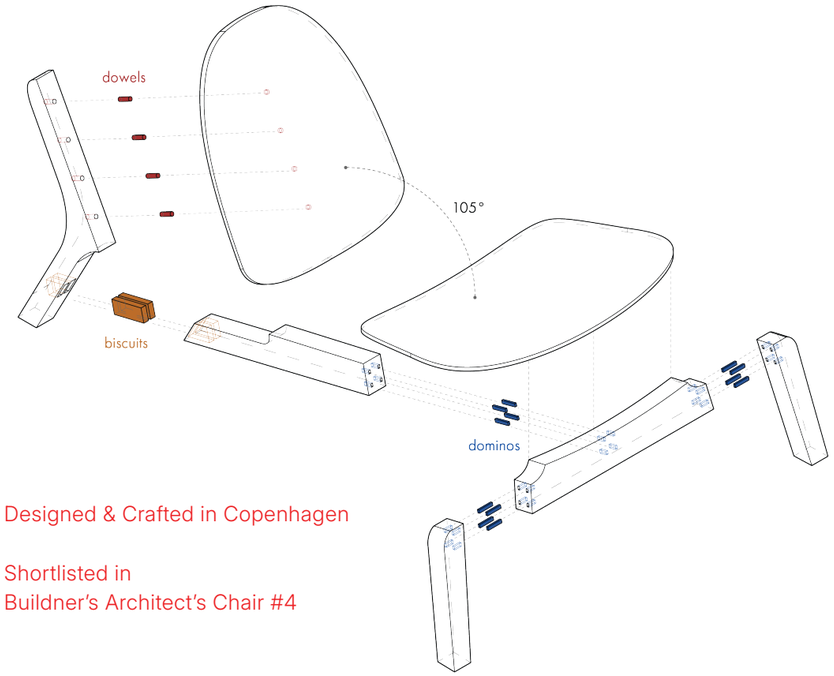


Library

Workshop

Furniture Design
Handcrafted

Water-based Polycrylic Finish
Ash Wood
Plywood



Designed & Crafted in Copenhagen

Shortlisted in
Buildner's Architect's Chair #4

Born From Timeless Icons, Designed To Be Lived With

Many iconic lounge chairs are timeless in form, yet their comfort and accessibility have often faded with time—once created for everyday living, they are now luxury symbols, crafted with complexity and priced out of reach. The Lo Chair seeks to reclaim that spirit of simplicity.

Drawing inspiration from modernist classics like Wegner's CH07 and the Eames DCW, the design captures their elegance and comfort while distilling the form into something minimal, modern, and approachable.

Selected Work

2024-2026

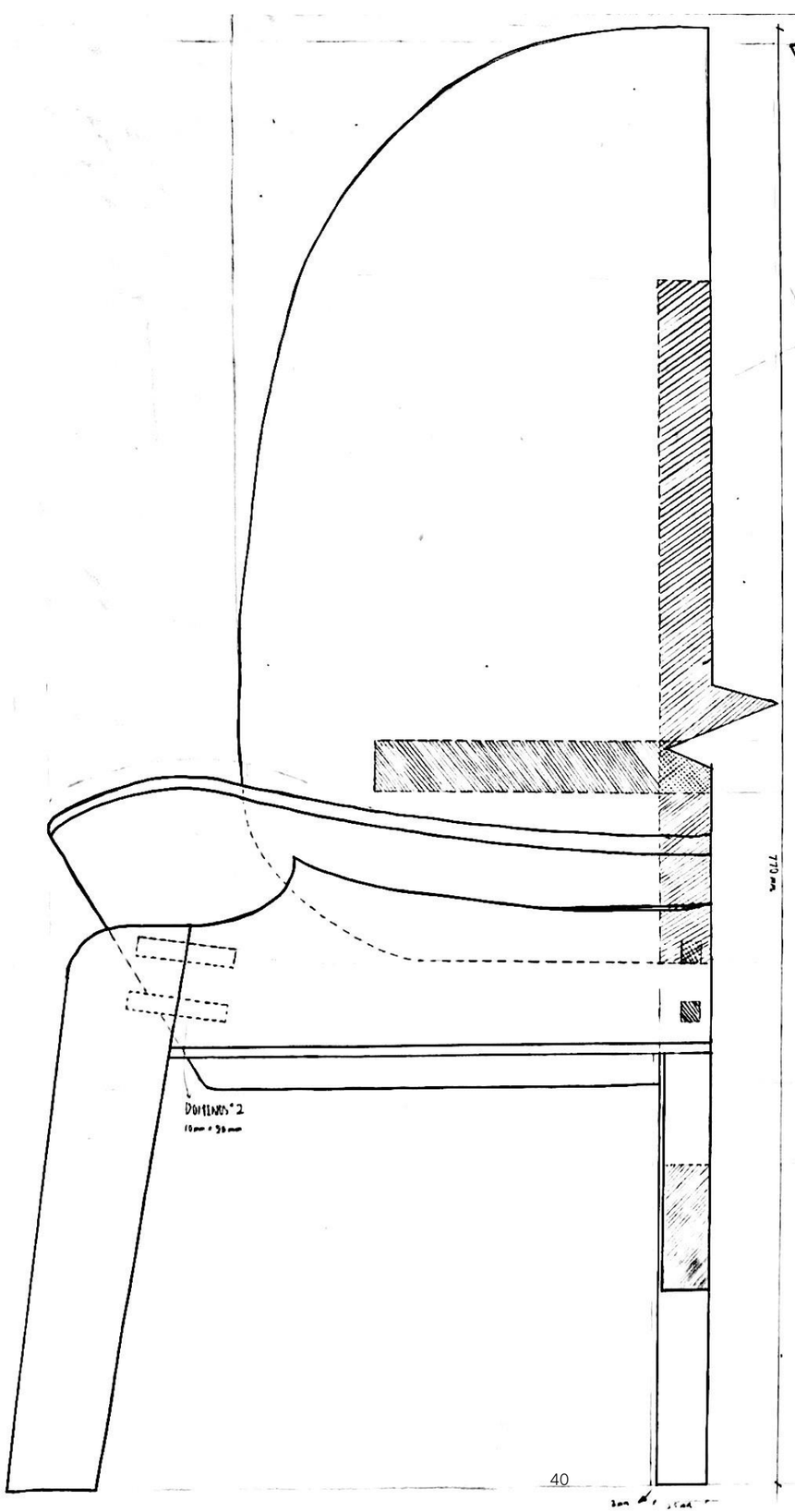
The Lo Chair

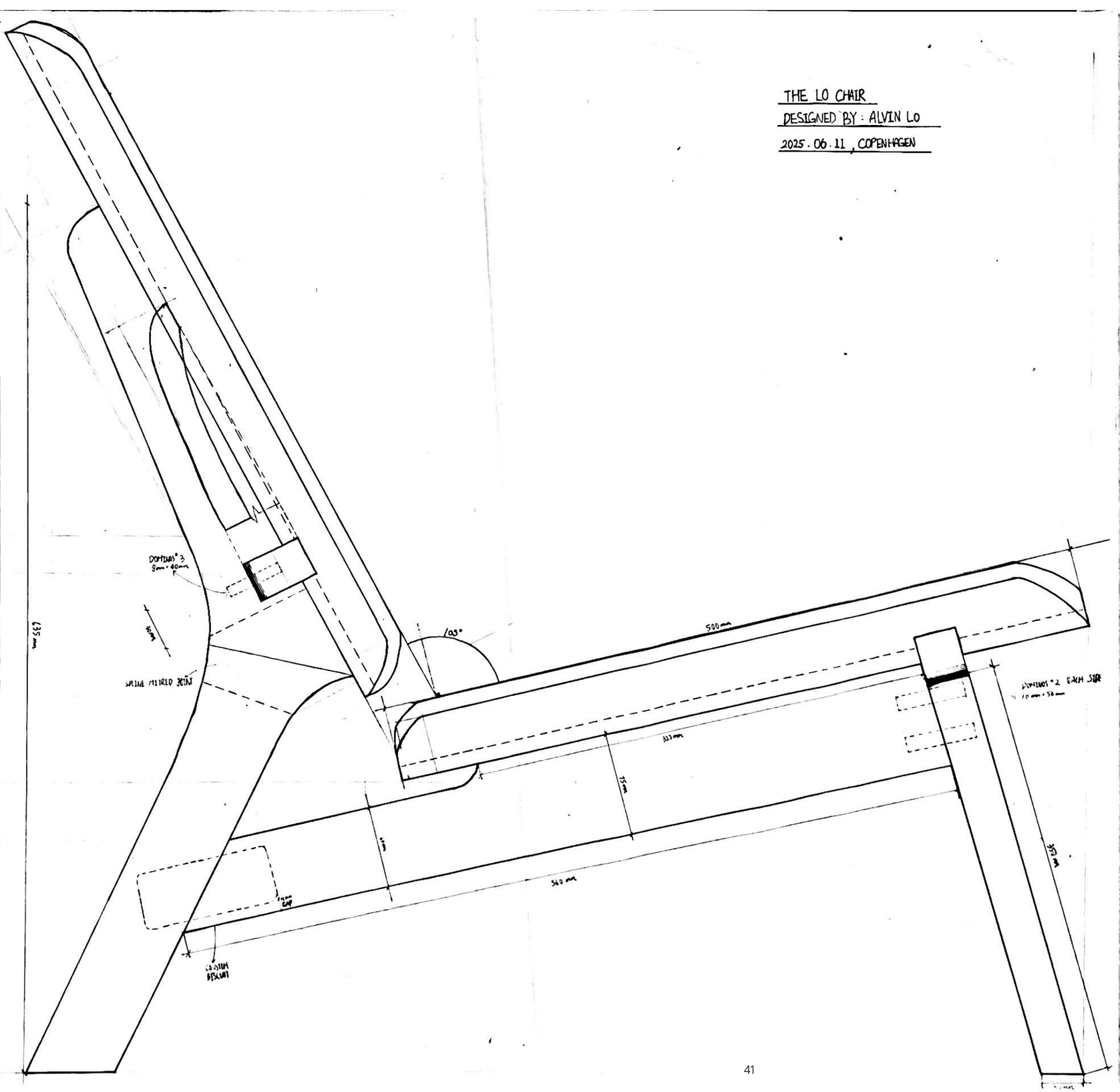
Shih Hsuan (Alvin) Lo

THE LO CHAIR

DESIGNED BY : ALVIN LO

2025.06.11 , COPENHAGEN





Changing Ties

Installation Design
Physical Model

1/8" Cotton Mason Line
Pinewood
Bamboo

Shih Hsuan (Alvin) Lo

Site: Brooklyn, NY 11205 (Osteria Brooklyn)
Instructor: Sheryl Kasak - INT 602
May 2024. Academic
Group Work

Re-Imagining Dining Sheds in NYC

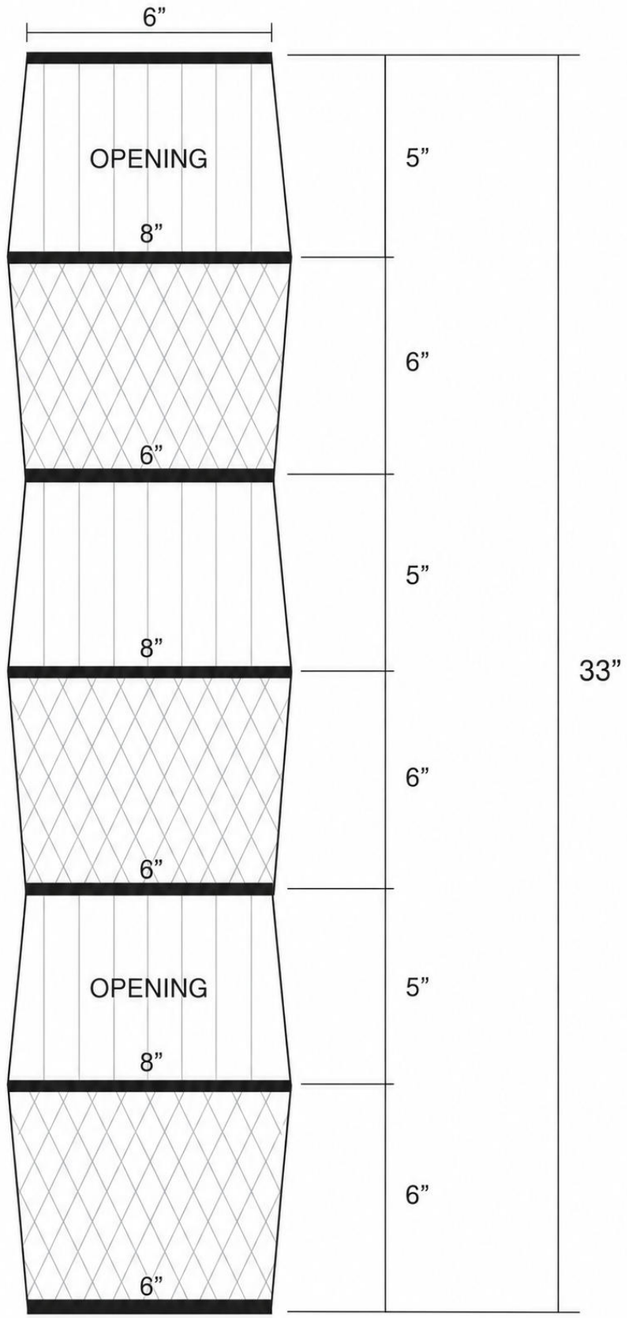
During the COVID-19 pandemic, New York City's outdoor "dining sheds" emerged as a temporary lifeline for restaurants under indoor dining restrictions. Occupying sidewalks and curbside parking, these structures offered sheltered, socially distanced seating and became symbols of urban resilience—while also stirring debate over safety, noise, and the use of public space.

Changing Ties reimagines these soon-to-be-abandoned sheds as fresh air pantries, transforming them into hubs for fresh food and community engagement through partnerships with local farms and agriculture-focused organizations. Knotted containers store and display seasonal produce for rotating, food-centered programs, fostering a new kind of shared public space where food, culture, and neighborhood identity intertwine.

Physical Model

SCALE - 1/2

SCALE - FULL



Container No. 1

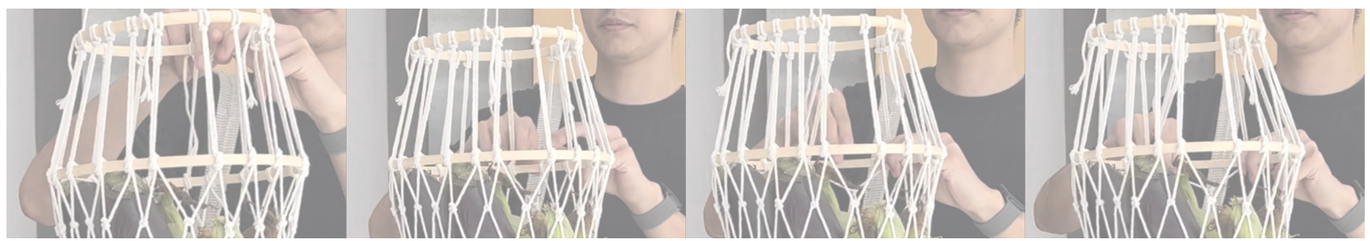
Small Produce

garlic
ginger
brussels sprouts
beets
mushrooms
fingerling potatoes

14 knots

- smaller hoop diameters mean that fewer knots are needed to create a high density for small produce
- depths of containers are shortened so overall length isn’t too long
- 33” length allows for comfortable access at both the highest and lowest openings

for smaller containers, 6” depth allows for easy access and still holds ample volume of smaller produce

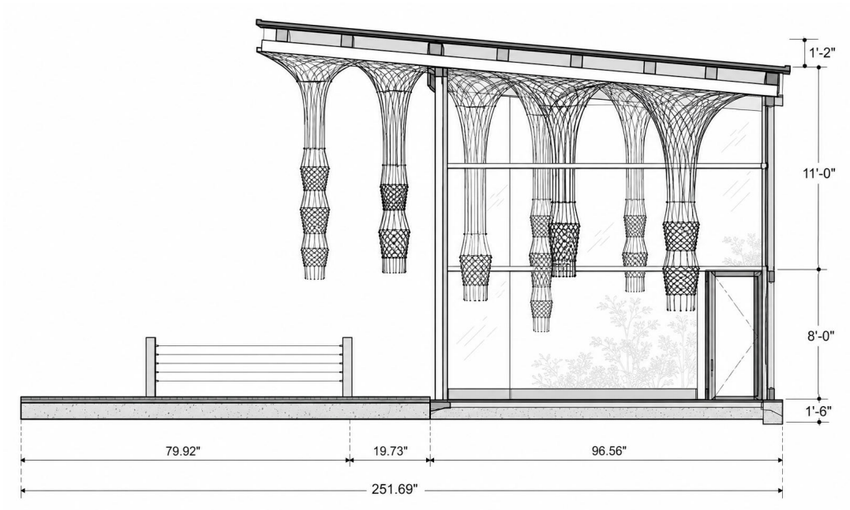


testing the container opening

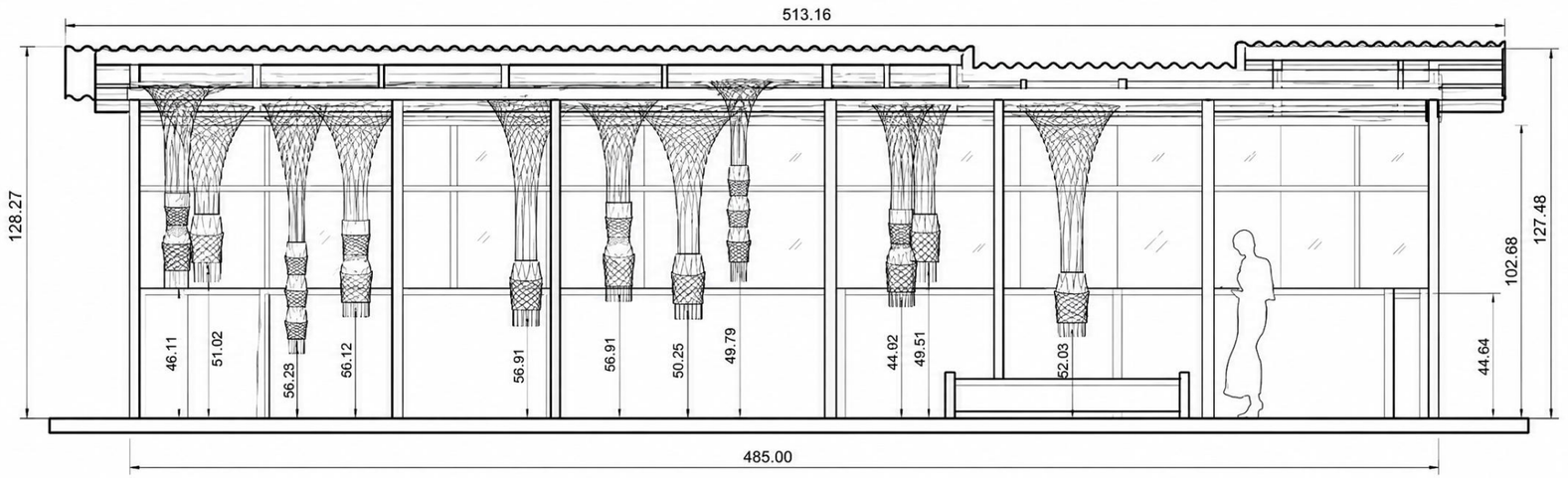
- knots slide easily on the hoop to create larger openings to access produce
- 26 knots between 8"-10" diameter hoops is the maximum , and is a bit dense for easy access; 14-20 knots allows for larger openings and greater accessibility
- 5" is a good opening length for small-medium produce; 7"-8" is necessary for larger produce

In Situ Installation

Containers designed, fabricated, and installed by Shih Hsuan Lo and four other production team members.



SECTION
SCALE: 1/2"=1'-0"



ELEVATION
SCALE: 1/2"=1'-0"

Library - L

Academic Design
Rendering

Rhino 7
V-Ray

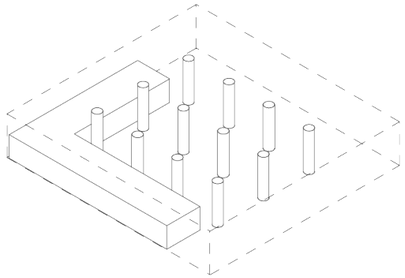
Site: Brooklyn, NY 11206 (Pfizer Building)
Instructor: Francine Monaco - INT 701
Dec. 2024. Academic
Individual Work

Learning / Film Screening Civic Center In Brooklyn

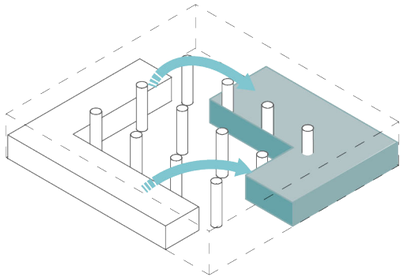
In a neighborhood where three traditional libraries already stand, one space dares to take a different approach. Library–L is conceived as both a civic center and a training ground, where residents can gain technical skills, explore new knowledge, and gather in an atmosphere that invites curiosity. Its open circulation draws people inward, leading them to a unique stair–reading area that becomes the heart of the community—a place to linger, connect, and learn.

While conventional libraries meet many needs, Bedford–Stuyvesant faces the pressures of rapid gentrification. Inspired by libraries such as Hunters Point and Oodi, this design offers a versatile learning environment that balances maximized collection space with open, flexible areas and reading zones of varied privacy—supporting a community in flux with a space that evolves alongside it.

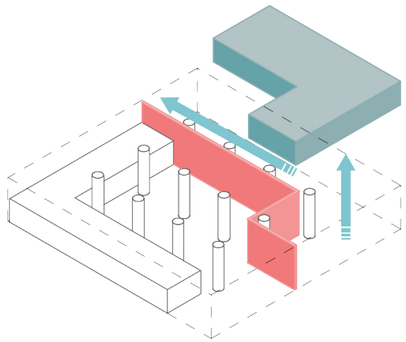
DESIGN STRATEGY



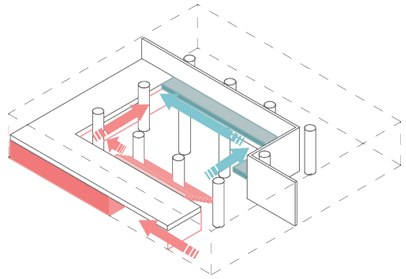
EXSITING CONDITION



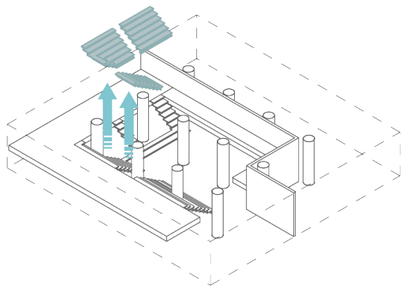
DERIVATIVE SHAPE



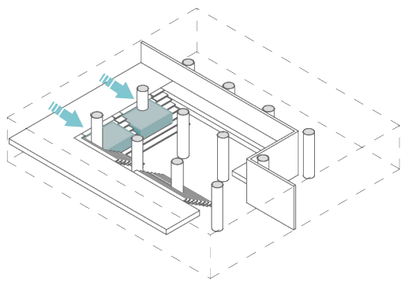
EXTENSION



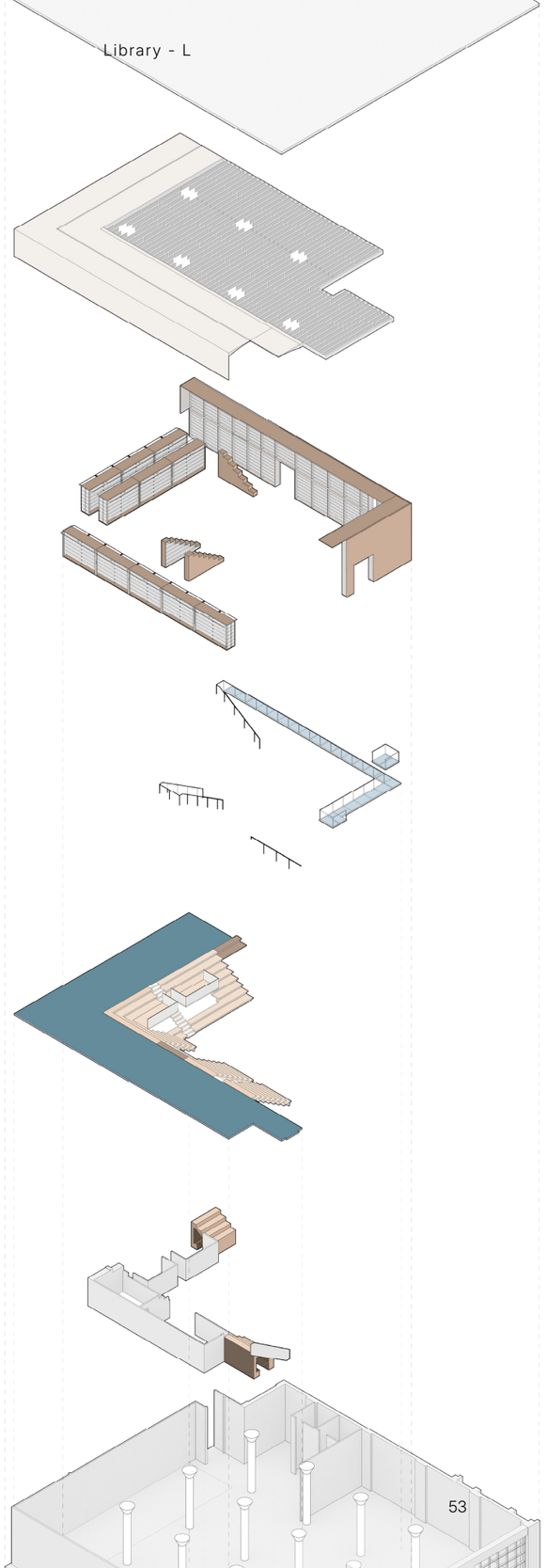
STADIUM SEATING +
CATWALK / L SHAPED



READING SPACE
UNDER MEZZANINE



EXTRUSION



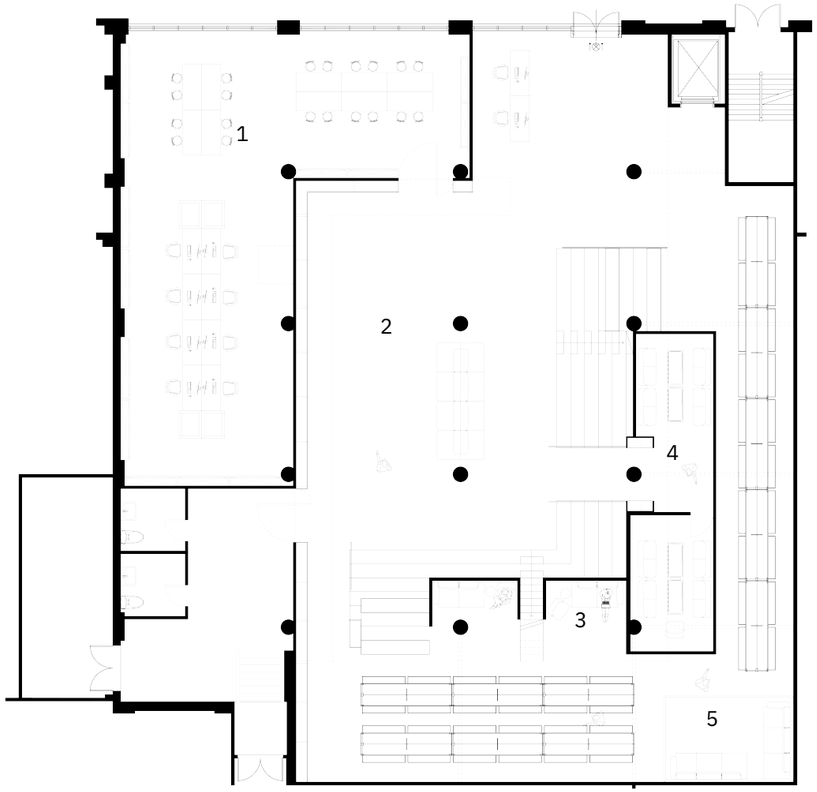
ACOUSTIC PANEL CEILING

BOOKSHELF + BOOK WALL

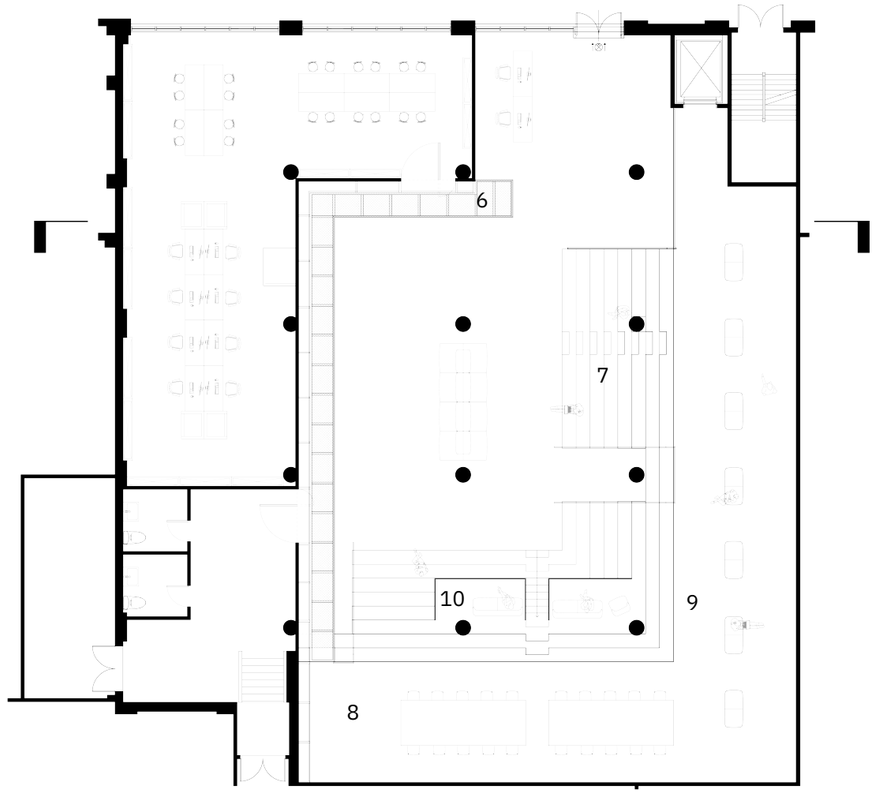
CATWALK + RAILING

STAIRS + STADIUM SEATITNG

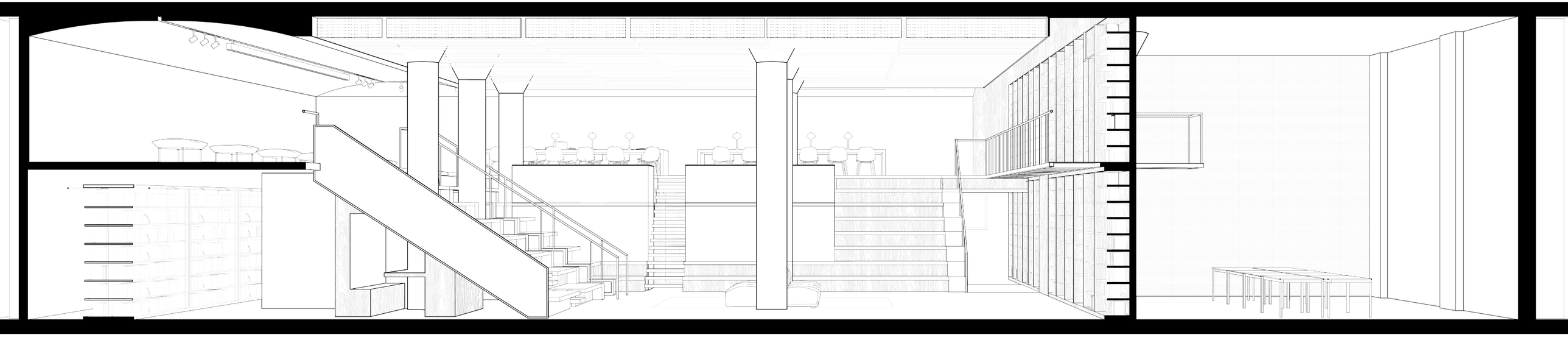
READING SPACES



1. Learning lab
2. Open reading area
3. Semi-open reading area
4. Reading rooms
5. Collection area



6. Catwalk
7. Stadium seating
8. Open reading area
9. Exhibition space
10. Reading booth



Section Perspective

Film screening

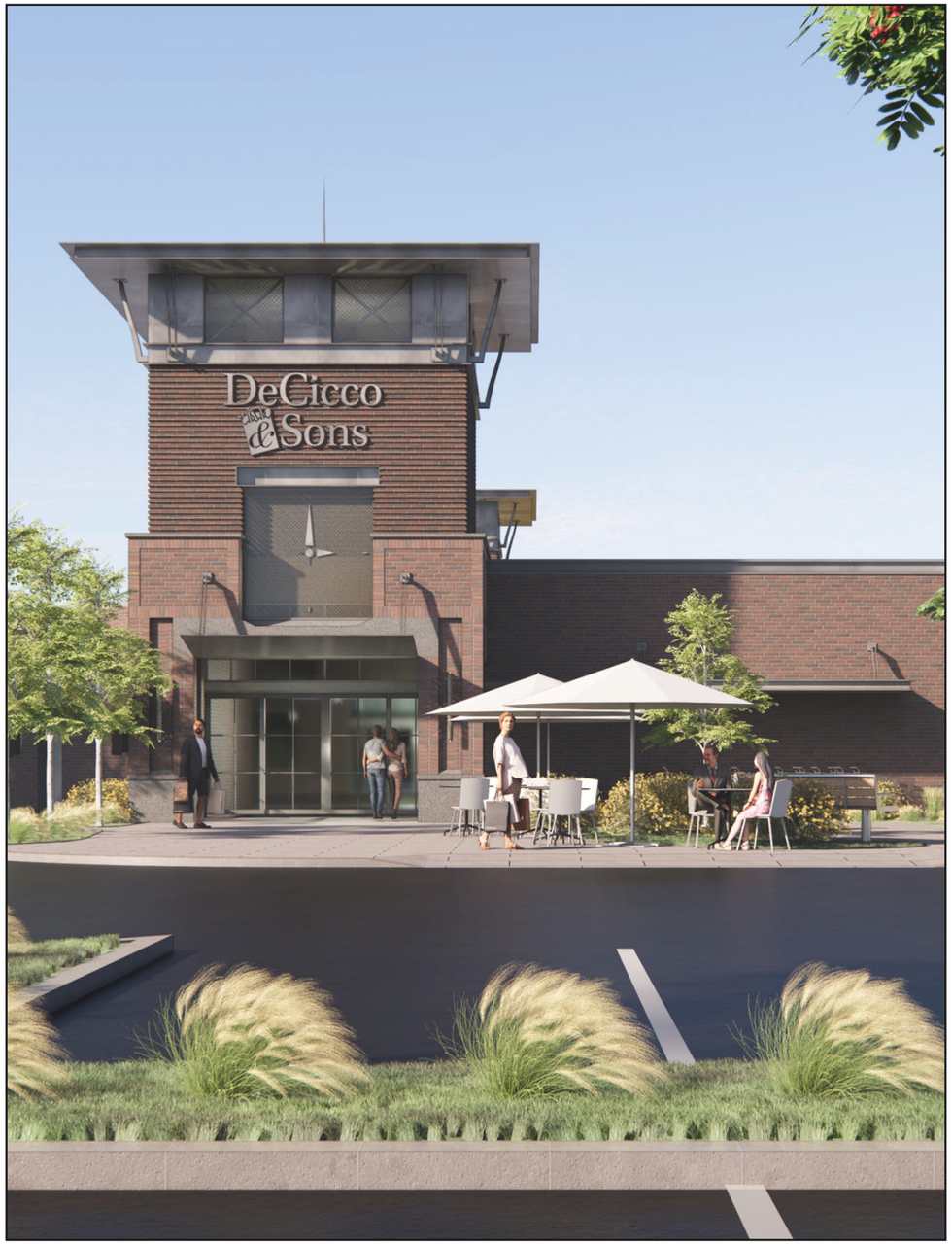
Gallery Space

Mezzanine View

Catwalk View

Threshold Under Mezzanine

Studio RAI Architects



Work Experience
Completed - 2025

Rhino 7
Enscape

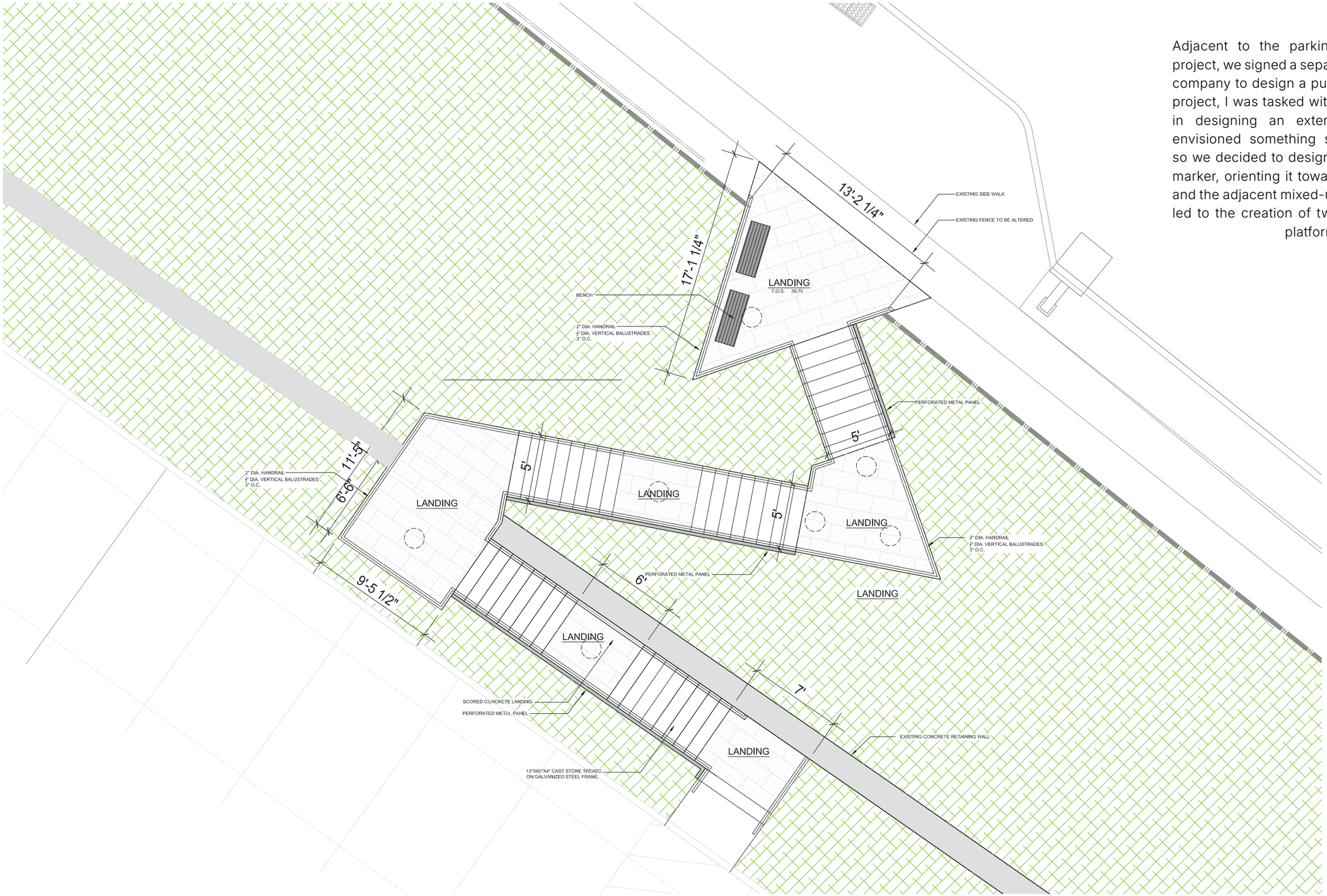
Site: Sleepy Hollow, NY 10591
Client: DeCicco & Sons
Size: 20,000 sqft
May–August 2024. Professional

Supermarket Department Design

Mixed Use Commercial Building In Sleepy Hollow

Before my internship began, the exterior of the project had already been completed. Spanning 20,000 square feet, this mixed-use building was designed for DeCicco & Sons, a supermarket in upstate New York. The first floor houses a supermarket with multiple departments, while the second floor features a variety of restaurants and a beer garden.

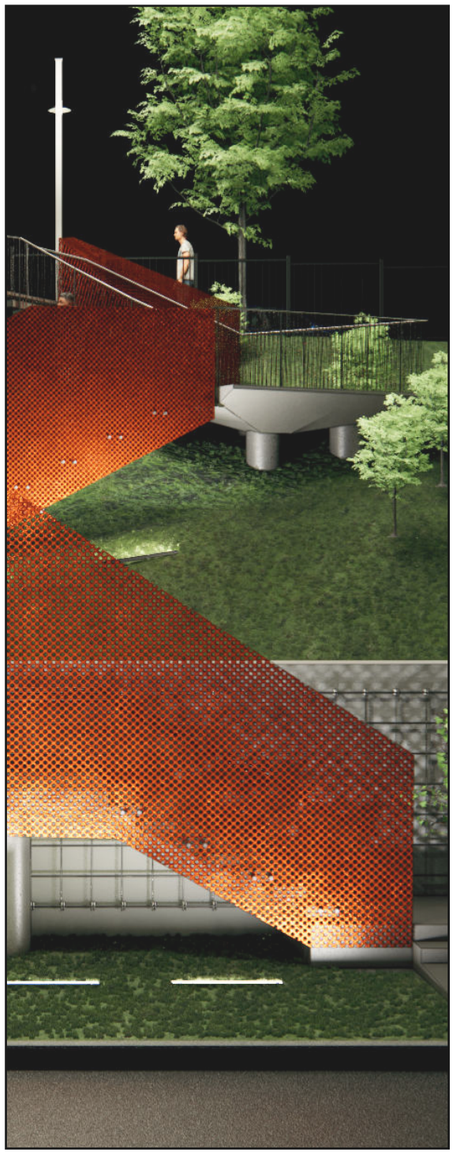
I feel incredibly fortunate to have been part of this project. As a junior designer, it's rare to have the opportunity to work on a project of this scale — let alone as an intern.



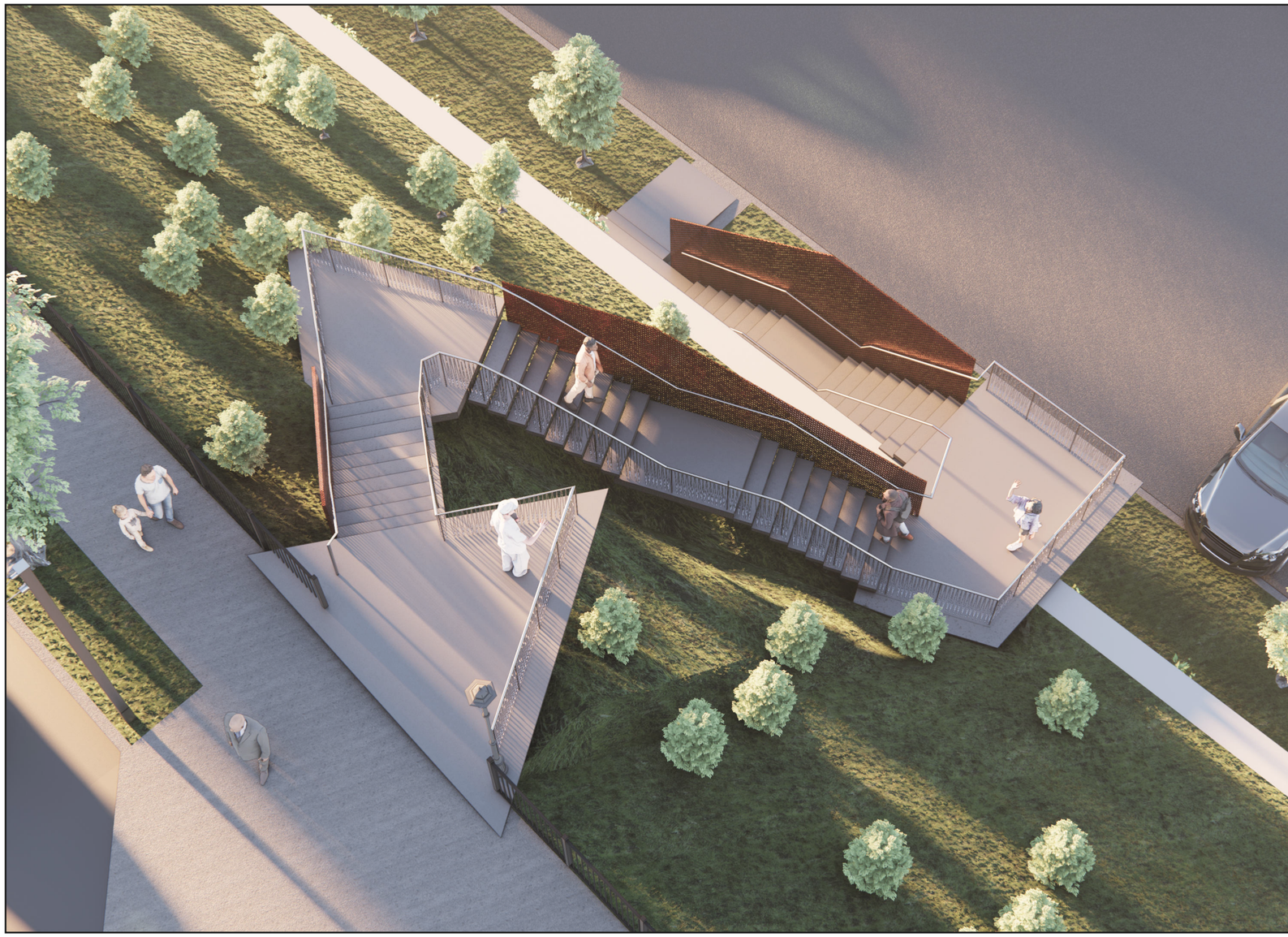
Adjacent to the parking area of the previous project, we signed a separate contract with another company to design a public space. As part of this project, I was tasked with assisting my supervisor in designing an exterior staircase. My boss envisioned something structural and sculptural, so we decided to design the staircase as a visual marker, orienting it toward both the Hudson River and the adjacent mixed-use building. This concept led to the creation of two exaggerated triangular platforms that define the design.

EXTERIOR STAIRS DESIGN

Day



Night



Dawn

City Pop

Academic
Rendering

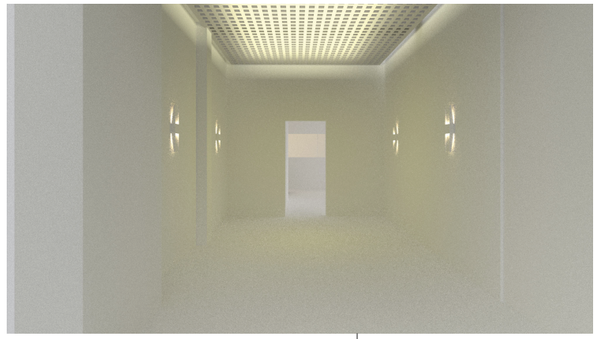
Rhino 7
V-Ray

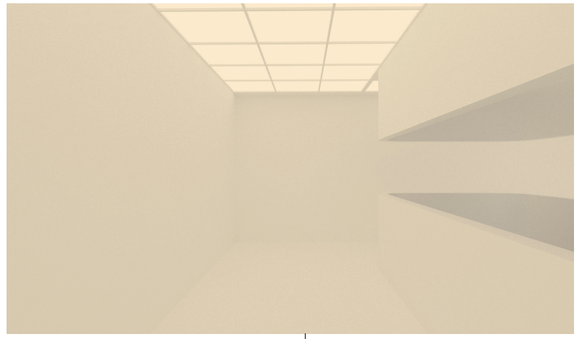
Artwork by Japanese artist Hiroshi Nagai

A Pop Up of Nostalgia

Inspired by Hiroshi Nagai's art, this pop-up for vinyl records and cassettes captures the airy, funky spirit of 1980s city pop. James Turrell's work also informed the design. Light, color, and carefully selected materials create a dynamic, fluid composition.

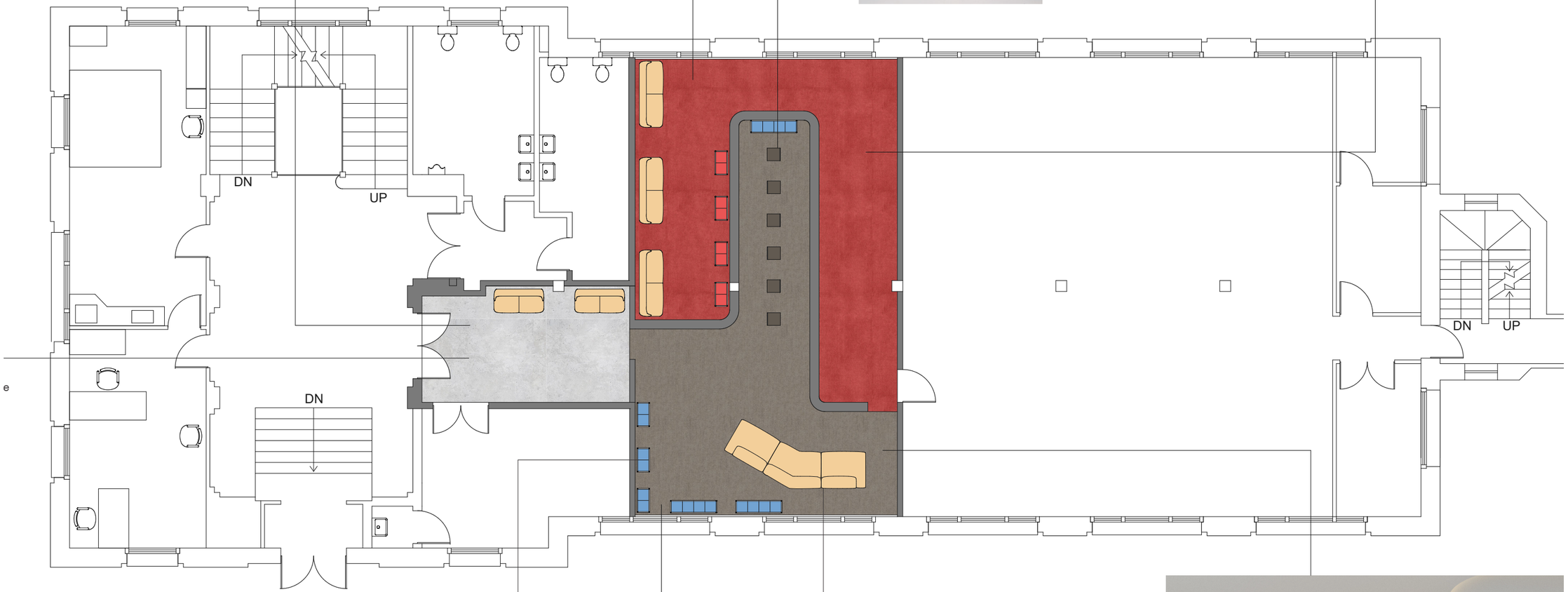
Site: Pratt Institute, Schaffler Gallery
Instructor: Sarah Hill
Dec. 2024. Academic
Individual Work





Red Carpet

Judd Chairs

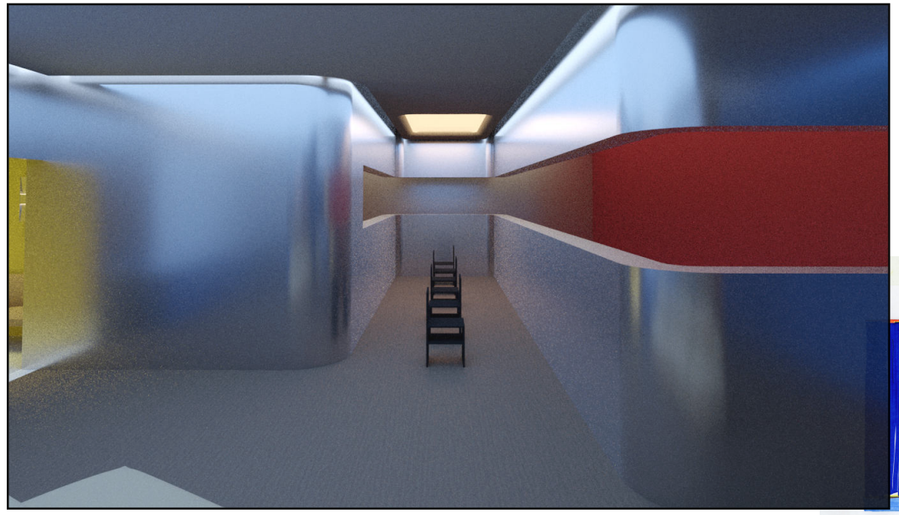


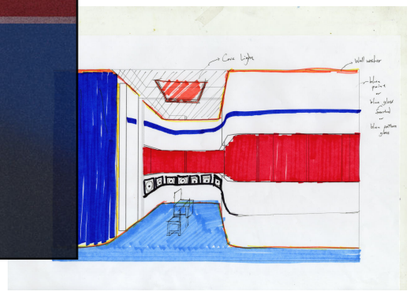
The space is divided into three distinct areas, each marked by a dramatic shift in mood. This transformation is driven by the bold use of color and a variety of lighting fixtures. Thoughtfully selected furniture also plays a key role in shaping the overall design of the pop-up.

USM x Symbol

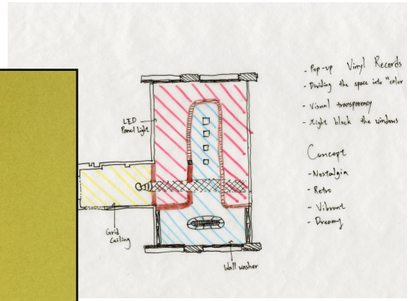
Dark Beige Carpet

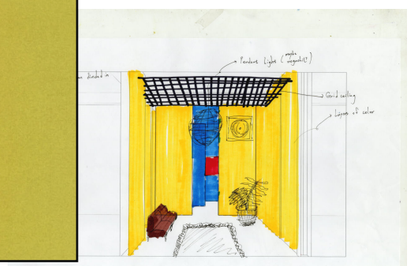
Muuto Modular Sofa





Room 1





Entrance

As occupants step into the entrance, a “window” offers a preview of the three distinct spaces, providing a glimpse of what lies ahead.

Room 2